THE COMPARATIVE HEALTH OUTCOMES, POLICY & ECONOMICS INSTITUTE

THE CHOICE INSTITUTE

SCHOOL OF PHARMACY | ANNUAL REPORT 2025

ANNIVERSARY EDITION 30 YEARS



UNIVERSITY of WASHINGTON

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OUR **MISSION**

Research: Develop innovative methods and generate actionable evidence about the effectiveness, safety, and value of medical products and services that improve decision making in health care and policy.

Training: Provide transformative training in health economics, outcomes research, and policy analysis to meet contemporary health care challenges regionally, nationally, and globally.

Service: Be a leading resource on the effectiveness, safety, and value of medical products and services by providing expertise and facilitating collaborations at the regional, national, and global level.

OUR COMMITMENT TO **DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION**

CHOICE is committed to creating an inclusive academic community where every individual is treated fairly and with dignity and respect. We strongly believe that diversity enriches learning, broadens the perspectives of all in our program, and improves our sense of community. Diversity requires an atmosphere of inclusion, tolerance, respect, and equity.

Our equality and diversity principles:

- We value the tremendous diversity of the human experience and believe that this diversity strengthens our communities and our program.
- We believe that discrimination or exclusion based on individual characteristics and circumstances, such as age; disability; caring or dependency responsibilities; gender or gender identity; marriage and civil partnership status; political opinion; pregnancy and maternity; race, color, caste, nationality, ethnic or national origin; religion or belief; sexual orientation; socioeconomic status; or other distinctions, is unjust and represents a waste of talent and a denial of opportunity for self-fulfillment.
- We recognize that patterns of under-representation and differences in outcomes at CHOICE can be challenged through positive action.
- We respect the rights of individuals, including the right to hold their own opinions and beliefs, but will not allow these opinions to be manifested in a way that is hostile or degrading to others.
- We expect commitment and involvement from all our faculty, staff, and students in working towards the achievement of our vision.

EDITORIAL SUPPORT PROVIDED BY: MARINA GANO, LEANA DE LA TORRE, MAYA KIMURA, RYAN HANSEN, ANIRBAN BASU, JING LI, JANICE JANG, ALEX TU, EMILY CALLEN, MANPREET DHANKHAR, SMRITI PATIL, SCOTT BRASWELL

CHOICE FACULTY & STAFF

Core Faculty

Jennifer Bacci, MPH, PharmD
Associate Professor, Endowed Professor in Innovative Pharmacy Practice (I2P2)

Aasthaa Bansal, MS, PhD
Professor

Douglas Barthold, PhD
Associate Professor, CHOICE Endowed Faculty Fellow, Associate Graduate Program Director

Anirban Basu, PhD
Stergachis Family Endowed Director & Professor

Josh Carlson, MPH, PhD
Professor, Director, Graduate Program

Clayton English, PharmD
Assistant Professor

Shelly Gray, PharmD, MS
Plein Endowed Professor; Director of the Plein Center for Aging

Ryan Hansen, PharmD, PhD
Professor, Chair, Department of Pharmacy

Laura Hart, PharmD, MS
Assistant Professor

Noémi Kreif, PhD, MA, Msc
Assistant Professor

Kyu Lee, PhD
Assistant Professor

Jing Li, MA, PhD
Associate Professor, Associate Director of CHOICE

Andy Stergachis, PhD, MS, BPharm
Professor

Sean D. Sullivan, BScPharm, PhD
Professor

David Veenstra, PharmD, PhD
Professor

Emeritus Faculty

Beth Devine, PharmD, MBA, PhD
Professor Emeritus

Louis Garrison Jr., PhD
Professor Emeritus

Thomas Hazlet, DrPH, PharmD
Associate Professor Emeritus

Adjunct Faculty

David Au, MS, MD
Professor of Medicine, UW, and Executive Director, US Department of Veteran's Affairs

Brian Bresnahan, PhD
Research Associate Professor, UW/HMC Department of Radiology

David Flum, MD, MPH
Professor, Division of General Surgery, UW

Lurdes Inoue, MS, MS, PhD
Professor, Department of Biostatistics, UW

Jerry Jarvik, MD, MPH
Professor, Department of Neurological Surgery, UW

Larry Kessler, ScD
Professor, Department of Health Systems and Population Health, UW

Gary Lyman, MD, MPH
Professor, Department of Medicine, UW

Scott Ramsey, MD, PhD
Professor, Director, Hutchinson Institute for Cancer Outcomes Research and Evaluation

Monisha Sharma, PhD
Associate Professor, Global Health

Staff

Leana de la Torre
Online Certificate Program Manager

Marina Gano, M.Ed.
Graduate Program & Operations Manager

Greg Guzauskas, PhD
Senior Research Scientist

Linda Luu, MS
Biostatistician

Affiliate Faculty

Blythe Adamson, Flatiron Health

Maria Agapova, Gilead Sciences

Carrie Bennette, Weave

Lisa Bloudek, Curta

Denise Boudreau, Genentech

Elizabeth Brouwer, Curta

William Canestaro, WRF

Ruth Etzioni, Fred Hutchinson Cancer Center

Jens Grueger, Boston Consulting Group

Jan Hansen, Sanofi

Brett Hauber, Pfizer

Zsolt Hepp, Bicycle Therapeutics

Nina Hill, Private Consulting

Zachary Marcum, Medicus Economics

Joshua Roth, Pfizer

Carolyn Rutter, Fred Hutchinson Cancer Center

Parth Shah, Fred Hutchinson Cancer Center

Lotte Steuten, Office of Health Economics (OHE)

Amy Tung, Curta

Sepideh Varon, Novartis

Elisabeth Vodicka, Pfizer

John Watkins, Premera Blue Cross

Jennifer Whiteley, Oracle

Davene Wright, Harvard Medical School

Kai Yeung, Amazon

Marita Zimmermann, IDM, Gates Foundation

DIRECTOR'S WELCOME



Dear friends and colleagues,

This year marks a remarkable milestone in the journey of The CHOICE Institute at the University of Washington — our 30th anniversary. Since its founding in 1995, CHOICE has grown from a bold vision into a global leader in health economics, outcomes research, and pharmaceutical policy. What began as a pioneering academic home for the study of cost-effectiveness and pharmaceutical policy has evolved into an interdisciplinary powerhouse committed to advancing evidence-based health policy, patient-centered decision-making, and equitable access to care.

Over the past three decades, our faculty, students, alumni, and partners have shaped public health conversations, influenced national policy, and driven innovations in health technology assessment and real-world evidence. We have built enduring collaborations across academia, government, and industry, while staying anchored in our core mission: to improve population health through rigorous, policy-relevant research, training, and service.

As we mark the 30th anniversary of The CHOICE Institute, this year's Annual Report serves not only as a reflection of our accomplishments, but as a tribute to the people, ideas, and partnerships that have shaped our journey. It is a celebration of CHOICE's enduring mission and the vibrant intellectual community that continues to define us.

The report highlights a diverse portfolio of ongoing research at CHOICE, spanning critical areas such as pharmaceutical pricing and access, vaccine and physician payment policies, medication adherence, and the application of cutting-edge data science methods to health care. These projects reflect our commitment to addressing complex health policy challenges through rigorous, policy-relevant scholarship.

We extend heartfelt congratulations to our graduating PhD students — Zizi Elsisi, Felipe Montano-Campos, and Ashley Tabah — as well as our graduating MS students: Minseon Chung, Divya Jain, Rachel Kneitel, Jean Lee, Kevin Li, Kathryn Perkins, Nissen Weisman, and Olivia Yip. We are equally delighted to welcome our incoming MS fellows who joined us in July and our new PhD cohort beginning in the fall. Their presence ensures the continued vitality and excellence of our academic community. And, we congratulate our 2024-2025 certificate students on successful program completions — the inaugural cohort of our newest program, the Certificate in Data Science in Health Economics & Outcomes Research (HEOR), and the 13th cohort of our long-established Certificate in HEOR. We appreciate the engagement and experience professionals bring to our continuing education training programs.

We are also proud to recognize several distinguished achievements within our faculty. Professor Beth Devine has been elected President-Elect of ISPOR – The Professional Society for Health Economics and Outcomes Research, continuing CHOICE's legacy of leadership within the field. Her election follows in the esteemed footsteps of CHOICE faculty luminaries including Sean Sullivan, Lou Garrison, Scott Ramsey, Dan Malone, Shelby Reed, and Jens Grueger.

Additionally, congratulations to Professor Shelly Gray, Director of the Plein Center for Aging, for being named a 2025 Fulbright Scholar — a well-deserved honor that reflects her global contributions to research and education in aging and medication use. Finally, we are all sad to see our long-term colleague, Professor Aasthaa Bansal, leave and join the University of Toronto in her hometown, but we have no doubt that our collaboration with her will continue unabated.

Our students have also garnered impressive accolades this year. Tori Dayer, a fifth-year PhD student, was recognized with the School of Pharmacy 2025 Graduate Student Leadership Award, honoring her outstanding impact on the program and her peers. Zizi Elsisi received the 2025 School of Pharmacy Outstanding Dissertation Award, a testament to the scholarly excellence and policy relevance of her doctoral work. Manpreet Dhankhar, a second-year PhD student, was selected as a 2025 Bonderman Fellow, further exemplifying the breadth of talent within our student body. Additional details on these and other student achievements can be found in the report.

In April, CHOICE proudly hosted the 2025 Western Pharmacoeconomics Conference (WPEC), which convened faculty, students, and professionals from across Western North America in a vibrant exchange of ideas in health economics and outcomes research. I am deeply grateful to the faculty, students, and staff who organized this successful and forward-looking program.

I would like to extend special thanks to the Department of Pharmacy administrative team — particularly Marina Gano and Leana de la Torre — whose dedication and behind-the-scenes work are indispensable to the daily operations and long-term success of CHOICE. I also wish to acknowledge the broader HEOR community for their continued collaboration and support through research, mentorship, and partnership. In an era marked by heightened scrutiny and evolving challenges to sustaining advanced training and research, the steadfast support of our friends, alumni, and advisory board members remains truly invaluable.

As part of this milestone year, we offer a retrospective on CHOICE's founding, growth, and scholarly contributions. It is a moment to honor our founders, to take stock of our legacy, and to look ahead — to the next chapter of innovation, training, and impact — with both humility and aspiration.

Wishing you all a healthy and fulfilling year ahead.

Sincerely,



Anirban Basu

Stergachis Family Endowed Director and Professor

The CHOICE Institute

CLASS OF 2025

DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY (HEALTH ECONOMICS & OUTCOMES RESEARCH)



Zizi Elsisi

BPharm in Pharmacy, 2014 - Cairo University; M.S. in Pharmaceutical Sciences (Health Outcomes), 2020 - University of Cincinnati

DISSERTATION: *Evaluating the Medicaid subscription-based payment model in Hepatitis C*

CHAIR: Anirban Basu

UPCOMING PLANS: Data Scientist, Value Analytics Labs



J. Felipe Montano-Campos

BA in Economics 2014, University of Buenos Aires; MS in Computer Science and Economics, 2020, Duke University

DISSERTATION: *Private Choices in Public Health: A Framework for Economic Epidemiological Modeling of Infectious Diseases*

CHAIR: Anirban Basu

UPCOMING PLANS: Postdoctoral Scholar at The Schaeffer Center for Health Policy & Economics, University of Southern California



Ashley Tabah

B.Sc. in Physiology, 2013 - McGill University; M.Sc. in Health Economics and Policy, 2014 - Barcelona School of Economics; MPH in Epidemiology, 2016 - Columbia University

DISSERTATION: *Understanding the outpatient medication use and spending of cognitively impaired older adults under changing Medicare Part D policy*

CHAIR: Ryan Hansen

UPCOMING PLANS: Associate Director, Health Economics and Outcomes Research at BioNTech

MASTER OF SCIENCE (HEALTH ECONOMICS & OUTCOMES RESEARCH)



Minseon Chung

PharmD/Master of Public Health, 2024 - University at Buffalo

THESIS: *Cost-Effectiveness of Delayed Progression in Alzheimer's Disease using Novel Monoclonal Antibodies*

CHAIR: Sean Sullivan

UPCOMING PLANS: Industry Fellowship Year 2; Novo Nordisk, Plainsboro Township, NJ



Divya Jain

B.S. in Biochemistry, 2020 - University of California Los Angeles; PharmD, 2024 - University of Colorado Anschutz Medical Campus

THESIS: *Urban-Rural Differences in Healthcare Utilization and Expenditures among Multiple Sclerosis patients in the United States*

CHAIR: Aasthaa Bansal

UPCOMING PLANS: Industry Fellowship Year 2; Genentech, San Francisco, CA



Rachel Kneitel

PharmD, 2024 - St. John's University

DISSERTATION: *Healthcare Resource Utilization and Economic Burden in Patients with AML Treated with Post-Transplant Maintenance Therapy*

CHAIR: Noémi Kreif

UPCOMING PLANS: Industry Fellowship Year 2; AbbVie, Chicago, IL

MASTER OF SCIENCE (HEALTH ECONOMICS & OUTCOMES RESEARCH)



Jean Lee

B.A. in Economics, 2011 - University of Michigan; PharmD, 2024 - University of Illinois Chicago

THESIS: *Healthcare resource utilization and costs in HFPEF patients treated with SGLT2-inhibitors and MRA vs. SGLT2-inhibitors and ARNI*

CHAIR: Ryan Hansen

UPCOMING PLANS: Industry Fellowship Year 2; Bayer, Whippany, NJ



Nissen Weisman

B.A. in Music 2015 - Southern Connecticut State University; BS in Pharmacy 2022 and PharmD 2024 - University of Connecticut

THESIS: *Healthcare Resource Utilization and Costs Attributable to US patients with Mantle Cell Lymphoma in the Third-Line Setting*

CHAIR: Dave Veenstra

UPCOMING PLANS: Industry Fellowship Year 2; Genentech, San Francisco, CA



Kevin H. Li

B.S. in Biochemistry & B.A. in Economics, 2020; PharmD, 2024 - University of Washington

THESIS: *Healthcare resource utilization and costs of commercially insured US patients with atopic dermatitis switching from first-line to second-line systemic targeted therapies*

CHAIR: Sean Sullivan

UPCOMING PLANS: Industry Fellowship Year 2; Sanofi, Cambridge, MA



Olivia Yip

B.S. in Biochemistry, 2019 – University of California, Los Angeles; PharmD, 2024 – University of California, San Diego

THESIS: *Healthcare Utilization and Cost Burden Associated with Depression among Patients with Alzheimer's Disease*

CHAIR: Kyu Lee

UPCOMING PLANS: Industry Fellowship Year 2; AbbVie, Irvine, CA



Kathryn Perkins

B.S. in Molecular Biology, 2017 – Evergreen State College; PharmD, 2024 - University of Southern California

THESIS: *Impact of Cachexia on Resource Utilization and Costs in Patients with Pancreatic, Lung, or Colorectal Cancers*

CHAIR: Josh Carlson

UPCOMING PLANS: Industry Fellowship Year 2; Pfizer, Bothell, WA









THIS PAGE, CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: GRADUATION CELEBRATIONS WITH FELIPE, ANIRBAN, JOSH, AND ASHLEY; DAVE VEENSTRA HOODS HIS STUDENT DIVYA AT THE SOP GRADUATION CEREMONY; ZIZI'S DISSERTATION DEFENSE.

WELCOME: NEW STUDENTS AND FELLOWS

PHD STUDENTS

Satoshi Koiso



Master of Development Practice, University of California at Berkeley; Bachelor of Veterinary Science (Doctor of Veterinary Medicine equivalent), University of Tokyo

ADVISOR: Jing Li

Satoshi is passionate about advancing global health policy through quantitative analysis to support evidence-based decision-making.

He worked in the public policy sector, including roles as a national government official in Japan, a consultant supporting policymakers, and a researcher at a global policy think tank. Before joining CHOICE, he worked at Massachusetts General Hospital, contributing to projects on travel-related infectious diseases and homelessness with opioid use disorder, using simulation modeling and economic evaluations. His research interests include decision science, infectious disease policy, and improving equitable healthcare for underserved populations worldwide. At CHOICE, Satoshi is aiming to bridge rigorous research with practical policy applications to improve global health.

Lijia Zheng



MPH in Biostatistics (Comparative Effectiveness Outcomes Research track), Columbia University Mailman School of Public Health; BA, Mathematics, Boston University

ADVISOR: Noémi Kreif

Lijia recently completed a Master of Public Health in Biostatistics at Columbia University, where she developed a strong foundation in statistical modeling and epidemiologic research. She previously earned her Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics from Boston University. Before joining the CHOICE Institute, she worked full-time as a research professional at Stanford Health Policy, where she contributed to projects in infectious disease modeling, policy evaluation, and the application of machine learning in healthcare. Through these projects, she became deeply interested in applying quantitative methods to inform health economics and policy decisions. Her current research interests center on infectious disease, aging populations, and the use of artificial intelligence to support decision-making in health economics and policy.



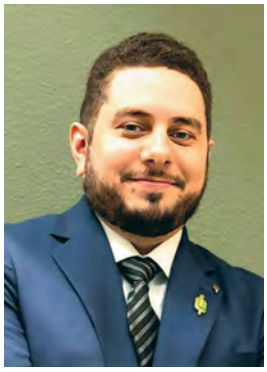
CHOICE FACULTY AND STUDENTS CELEBRATING GRADUATION.



NEW MS FELLOWS AFTER THEIR WEEKLY MARKETSCAN BOOTCAMP SESSION.

HEOR FELLOWS

Andrew Cotterill



UW/AbbVie HEOR Fellow
2025–2027

PharmD, Nova Southeastern University; BS in Computer Science, Full Sail University

ADVISOR: Noémi Kreif

Andrew is a PharmD graduate from Nova Southeastern University. His interest in HEOR developed during his pharmacoepidemiology research experiences, where he leveraged his computer science and programming background to synthesize data-driven evidence and model drug utilization with the goal of identifying treatment gaps to better inform patient care strategies. Under the guidance of the experts at CHOICE and AbbVie, Andrew is now focused on further developing his skillset and wants to explore the use of machine learning and AI in real-world evidence generation to improve the impact HEOR has on healthcare outcomes.

Janice Jang



UW/AbbVie HEOR Fellow
2025–2027

PharmD, University of Arizona

ADVISOR: Kyu Lee

Janice is an incoming first-year UW CHOICE-AbbVie HEOR fellow and is a recent PharmD graduate of the University of Arizona. She developed an interest in HEOR through various research experiences including her summer research internship at the University of Arizona on the cost-efficiency analysis of adalimumab and its biosimilars. She looks forward to enhancing her skill sets in data analysis, economic modeling, and real-world evidence generation and is motivated to improve patient access and health outcomes. Janice is eager to learn from the experts at the CHOICE Institute and AbbVie.

Jonathan Luong



UW/Genentech HEOR Fellow
2025-2027

PharmD, University of Washington; BA in Biochemistry, University of Washington

ADVISOR: Dave Veenstra

Jonathan is a recent PharmD graduate from the University of Washington School of Pharmacy. His previous HEOR experiences include internships and rotations within the pharmaceutical industry and consulting. He is looking forward to developing the technical skills necessary to further his growth in the field of HEOR and working with mentors from the CHOICE Institute and Genentech.

Jacob Vang



UW/Pfizer HEOR Fellow
2025-2027

PharmD, University of Minnesota – Twin Cities; BS in Biochemistry, University of Wisconsin-Madison

ADVISOR: Josh Carlson

Jacob recently earned his PharmD from the University of Minnesota and holds a BS in Biochemistry from the University of Wisconsin–Madison. He joins the CHOICE Institute as a UW/Pfizer HEOR Fellow. During pharmacy school, Jacob completed a project-based internship at MOBE, a health outcomes company in Minneapolis, where he contributed to many outcomes research initiatives. He was also actively involved in his local AMCP chapter, particularly through participation in the P&T competition, which further sparked his interest in health economics and real-world data. Jacob is especially interested in applying HEOR methods to oncology research and value assessment. Outside of work, he enjoys discovering new restaurants, has a passion for Vietnamese coffee, and loves sharing the fun fact that he has an identical twin brother.

CURRENT STUDENTS

PHD STUDENTS



Preetika Banerjee, MSPH

PhD Student (Year 2)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: TBD

ADVISOR: Kyu Lee



Zilin Cheng, MS

PhD Student (Year 3)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: TBD

ADVISOR: Jing Li



Shiven Bhardwaj, PharmD, MAS

PhD Student (Year 4)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: *Assessing Association Between 2019 CMS Rule and Use of Branded Drugs in Medicare Part D*

ADVISOR: Douglas Barthold



Emma Cousin, PharmD

PhD Student (Year 4)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: *Assessing Selecting and Negotiating Medicare Part B Drugs for IPAY 2028*

ADVISOR: Sean Sullivan

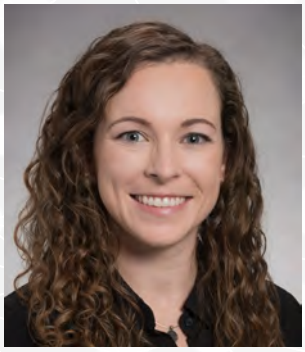


Emily Callen, MPH

PhD Student (Year 4)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: *Evaluating State HIV Pre-exposure Prophylaxis Drug Assistance Programs*

ADVISOR: Ryan Hansen



Tori Dayer, PharmD

PhD Student (Year 5)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: *The US Biosimilars Market: Economic Factors and Patient Out-of-Pocket Costs*

ADVISOR: Sean Sullivan



Hui-Hsuan Chan, MHS

PhD Student (Year 3)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: TBD

ADVISOR: Josh Carlson

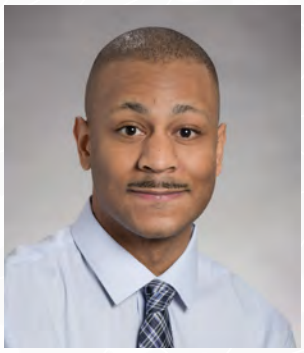


Manpreet Dhankhar, MS

PhD Student (Year 3)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: TBD

ADVISOR: Anirban Basu



Ronald Dickerson, MPH, MA

PhD Student (Year 5)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: *Firearm Injuries and Illicit Drug Markets: An Econometric Analysis of Costs, Violence, and Spatial Dependence*

ADVISOR: Anirban Basu



Karris Jeon, MS

PhD Student (Year 4)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: *Medicare Drug Price Negotiation: Projected Savings in 2026*

ADVISOR: Sean Sullivan



Julia Fox, MA

PhD Student (Year 4)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: *Modeling Information Sharing and Referral Acceptance Dynamics Among People who Inject Drugs*

ADVISOR: Kyu Lee

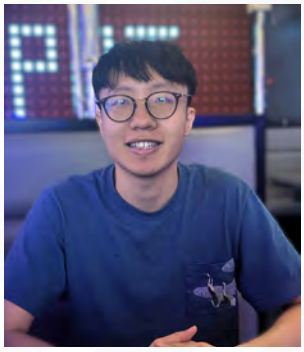


Ifechukwu (Ben) Nwogu, MPH

PhD Student (Year 5)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: *Therapeutic Innovations in Advanced Prostate Cancer: A Real-World Comparative Effectiveness and Cost-Effectiveness Evaluation*

ADVISOR: Josh Carlson



Sam Han, MSPH

PhD Student (Year 2)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: TBD

ADVISOR: Noémi Kreif



Carlos Pineda-Antunez, MS

PhD Student (Year 3)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: TBD

ADVISOR: Doug Barthold



Thomas Hopkins, PharmD, MS

PhD Student (Year 2)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: TBD

ADVISOR: Doug Barthold



Ruihan Qin, MS

PhD Student (Year 2)

DISSERTATION TOPIC: TBD

ADVISOR: Jing Li

CHOICE WELCOMES NEW LEADERSHIP

We are delighted to welcome Associate Professors Jing Li & Douglas Barthold to the CHOICE leadership team!



Jing Li, PhD | Associate Director, The CHOICE Institute

"Jing will bring great leadership in steering new projects, directions, and vision for CHOICE, which will keep our Institute maturing and blossoming." - Anirban Basu, Stergachis Family Endowed Director, The CHOICE Institute

"CHOICE to me is not only the academic home but a source of inspiration with an incredible range of creative research and training activities" says Dr. Li. "I am excited to contribute to the strategic direction and continued success of our institute as the Associate Director, further extending CHOICE's already wide-reaching impact on policymaking and population health."



Douglas Barthold, PhD | Associate Director, HEOR Graduate Program

Dr. Barthold says, "I'm delighted to join the CHOICE leadership team and contribute to our training mission as the Associate Graduate Program Director. Helping our students succeed in the Masters and Doctoral programs is immensely rewarding."

Doug will work closely with Professor Josh Carlson (Graduate Program Director), Marina Gano (Graduate Program Manager), and other CHOICE leadership to make sure we are continuing with our exceptional training for our students and helping them succeed.





Three Decades of CHOICE:

HONORING THE PAST, SHAPING THE FUTURE

Thirty years ago, a quietly ambitious idea began to take shape at the University of Washington — one that would go on to redefine how we measure value in healthcare, train generations of leaders, and build a model for collaborative, human-centered research.

Today, The Comparative Health Outcomes, Policy, and Economics (CHOICE) Institute — stands as one of the world's leading centers for health economics and outcomes research (HEOR). But its origins were humble. Its growth, deliberate. And its impact, profound.

A Foundation of Vision: The Early Years

The story begins in 1989, when Dr. Andy Stergachis joined the UW School of Pharmacy. With a background in pharmacy and public health, Stergachis saw an opportunity to create something beyond the traditional academic mold. In 1990, he began laying the groundwork for what would become the Pharmaceutical Outcomes Research and Policy Program — PORPP, the academic forerunner to CHOICE. Stergachis envisioned an institute that would anchor rigorous graduate training in applied pharmaceutical outcomes research — and help shape pharmacy's broader role in public health.

From the start, the work was policy-relevant and globally impactful. Stergachis' own research helped shift World Health Organization guidelines on anti-malarial drug safety during pregnancy. The ethos was clear: CHOICE would be about science, but also service. "The field has grown, and CHOICE has grown with it," he said. From substance use and tobacco cessation to maternal health and medical devices, CHOICE faculty and alumni are tackling the most complex issues in healthcare today — always with collaboration at the core.

ABOVE: FACULTY AND THE FIRST PORPP GRADUATING PHD CLASS IN 2001; RIGHT: STUDENTS AND FACULTY AT THE 2008 GRADUATION CEREMONY.

But Stergachis believes CHOICE's most lasting contribution may be its people. "Our alumni are changemakers," he said. "They're leading in government, industry, and global health. That's the legacy."

He and his wife Joanne have helped ensure that legacy continues — through endowments supporting global learning, faculty leadership, and future scholars. "It's about investing in the future," he said. "Because we're not done. Not even close."

Building a Research Engine: The Rise of Outcomes Science

Soon, Stergachis was joined by epidemiologist Dr. Jackie Gardner, and pharmacist and recent PhD health economist from UC Berkeley, Dr. Sean D. Sullivan. Together, they formed a nucleus of scholars committed to rigorous science, collaborative inquiry, and the belief

that pharmacy should be as much about population health as pills. When Sullivan arrived in 1991, the idea of evaluating "value for money" in healthcare was still novel, and they saw an urgent need to ask better questions in this space — and train people to answer them.

"CHOICE is a community," Sullivan said. "A home for educators, researchers, and students who are passionate about improving health outcomes through better decision-making."

In 1995 the team, support, and funding were in place; the time was right to officially establish PORPP and a new graduate program. Under Sullivan's leadership — as faculty, the Director of PORPP, and later dean — CHOICE helped pioneer the field of Health Economics and Outcomes Research (HEOR). Its graduate program became a launchpad for policy-influencing scientists. And its faculty — like Josh Carlson, Lou Garrison, Beth Devine, Dave Veenstra, Ryan Hansen, Aasthaa Bansal, and others — produced work that shaped real-world access, pricing, and regulation. "We're often cited as a top institute globally," Sullivan noted. "Not because of marketing — but because of the quality of our work, our dynamic students, and the staff behind it."

The Institute's impact can be seen in federal reforms, precision medicine policy, and groundbreaking cost-effectiveness methods. But its greatest influence, Sullivan said, may be its leadership pipeline: "Seven of the 30 ISPOR presidents have come from CHOICE. That's not an accident. That's a culture."

Careers Defined: Purpose and Progress

For Dr. Beth Devine, CHOICE has been more than an academic home, it has been her purpose. "It wasn't yet called CHOICE when I joined," she recalled. "But the energy and ambition were unmistakable."

Across her career, Devine's work has helped transform electronic health records, genomic screening, and evidence synthesis for national guidelines. She partnered across disciplines and continents, always keeping science in service to patients. "What sets CHOICE apart," she said, "is that our research is never in isolation. It's connected — to medicine, public health, informatics, and global policy."

Reflecting on the evolution of CHOICE, Devine sees the next chapter of the Institute already underway. "We're entering an era of real-world data, machine learning, and global collaboration," she said. "But the core remains: rigorous, patient-centered science — and a culture of mentorship that multiplies our impact."

Professor Emeritus Lou Garrison echoes Dr. Devine's perspectives and is pleased to see the evolution and success of CHOICE over these 30 years and its contribution to the science of HEOR. Having mentored many students and junior colleagues, including Dr. Devine, he said, "I have had the privilege and pleasure of working with the dedicated and talented CHOICE faculty, students, and staff over this entire period — first, at Roche, as collaborator and mentor, and then, as a faculty member. My debt is immense — as is my gratitude for my good fortune." In September 2022, Garrison received the Avedis Donabedian Outcomes Research Lifetime Achievement Award from ISPOR.

Dr. Josh Carlson, who serves as Graduate Program Director, sees collaborative culture as central to CHOICE's success. "It's not about individual excellence. It's about building something together," he said.

His work with the Institute for Clinical and Economic Review (ICER) has led to more than 25 health technology assessment models used across the country. "It's been a way to stay connected to both the policy implications and the methodological frontiers of our field. That dual relevance — rigor and impact — is what keeps CHOICE vibrant."

A Broader Identity: Redefining Choice

In 2014, when Sullivan became the Dean, he initiated the search for a new Director of PORPP. The search Committee, led by Andy Stergachis, identified Anirban Basu as the clear successor and he was appointed in 2015. At that time, the transformation from PORPP was already underway. But it was Basu who helped lead the redefinition. "Our faculty were working on vaccines, Alzheimer's, financial behavior," he said. "We needed a name — and an identity — that reflected that breadth."

Once CHOICE made its debut, it became an official university institute, unlocking broader scope and institutional support. Under Basu's leadership, the Institute deepened its focus on real-world evidence, health insurance, and machine learning. Faculty like Noémi Kreif, Douglas Barthold, Jing Li, and Kyu Lee have brought new energy — and new questions.

"What sets CHOICE apart," Basu said, "is that we train people not just to run models, but to interpret them. To connect economics, data, and ethics. That's the work of a social scientist."

He sees growing demand for that kind of thinking — and sees CHOICE rising to meet it. "Healthcare is complex. Our job is to make sense of that complexity, and to train the next generation to do the same."



A Culture of Belonging: Mentorship and Meaning

Since 1995, CHOICE has trained over 35 postdoctoral fellows, 90 master's students, 84 PhD students, and more than 600 certificate students. CHOICE Institute alumni are a diverse community of experts who continue to shape the field—and their stories reflect the heart of the program. Dr. Mark Bounthavong ('18) chose CHOICE not for the prestige—but for the people. He remembers entering the program with uncertainty, unsure whether he belonged in a rigorous PhD environment. But the culture he found at CHOICE quickly reshaped his expectations. "There were no stupid questions — only a shared mission to learn, grow, and contribute," he recalled. "They made me feel like part of a team."

That mentorship extended far beyond the classroom. When Bounthavong's father passed away, it was CHOICE faculty and peers who reached out with support, compassion, and presence. "That meant the world to me," he said. "It wasn't just academic — it was deeply human."

Today, as an Associate Professor of Clinical Pharmacy at UC San Diego, Bounthavong sees his work and mentorship style as a direct reflection of what CHOICE instilled in him—modeling the same accessibility and generosity he received, and carrying the CHOICE ethos into new institutions and communities. "We're all products of this place," he reflects. "And the way we honor it is by paying it forward — by mentoring others, by spreading the values, and by building environments that feel like CHOICE, wherever we go."

This culture of mentorship resonates with our most recent alumni. Dr. Felipe Montano-Campos ('25) shared, "For me, the most important part of CHOICE has been the mentorship and the chance to work with so many faculty across a range of topics. It also meant having the resources to attend conferences, meet more people in the field, and reconnect with CHOICE friends who are making their contributions all over the globe."

As Felipe begins a Postdoctoral Fellowship at the University of Southern California, he carries with him memories of friendship and a soft spot for his home of the past four years. "When I think of CHOICE, I think of a group of incredibly respected researchers in the field — who also happen to be people I genuinely enjoy being around. And, of course, I can't help but think of Seattle too."

The People Behind the Progress

For Penny Evans, a longtime staff member who joined UW in 1991, CHOICE's growth mirrored her own journey. When she first arrived, she had no idea she would be a part of one of the country's leading centers for health economics, outcomes research, and policy.



FIRST ANNUAL RETREAT AS THE CHOICE INSTITUTE, MAY 2018.

"I became involved when they were developing the program," she recalled. "I helped write and distribute the quarterly PORPP reports and then continued producing the annual reports until I retired. It was quite a journey."

But her contributions extended well beyond reports and logistics. She welcomed new students, supported faculty research efforts, and helped organize national conferences. Through it all, she found joy and meaning in the relationships she built. "The students were my favorite part," she said. "They're just phenomenal — so smart, so motivated. It gave me hope for the future."

Though she retired in 2017, Penny Evans still carries her CHOICE memories with pride. "It was bittersweet to leave, but I was proud of what we built. And I know it's in good hands — still growing, still evolving." For Penny, CHOICE wasn't just a workplace, it was a community that mattered — and still does. Her legacy lives on through the Penny Evans UW ISPOR Student Chapter Support Fund, established in 2017 to honor her lasting impact on the program. The fund supports student activities within the UW ISPOR chapter, fostering professional development and engagement with the global HEOR community.

Today, the administrative leadership of The CHOICE Institute is guided by Marina Gano, who joined in 2019 as the Graduate Program and Operations Manager. In 2023 she was joined by Leana de la Torre, serving as the CHOICE Online Certificate Manager. Their leadership, dedication, and genuine care for our students have helped carry forward Penny's legacy and sustain the supportive culture that defines CHOICE.

Data and Decency: The New Generation Carries it Forward

Faculty such as Jing Li, Douglas Barthold, Kyu Lee, and Noémi Kreif are advancing CHOICE's mission through innovative, data-driven research. At the same time, they remain deeply committed to the human-centered values that have long defined the Institute.

Jing Li, Associate Director of CHOICE, reflects that commitment in her research, which spans Medicare policy, pharmaceutical marketing, and end-of-life care. "We're asking hard questions

— about how we define value, how incentives affect prescribing, how policy changes affect patients in the real world," she said.

One of her recent studies on advance care planning showed how Medicare reimbursement shifted end-of-life outcomes for patients, which has opened new national healthcare practice discussions on how policy can align with patient preferences. "That's what we strive for — research that not only advances knowledge, but helps people live better lives."

Douglas Barthold, Associate Graduate Program Director, brings a health policy lens to his work on chronic disease management and cognitive decline. He emphasizes the importance of interpretation and empathy in a field increasingly driven by data. "AI is coming," he said. "But we have to teach what machines can't: judgment, critical thinking, compassion. That's the heart of our teaching mission."

Through complex simulation modeling, Kyu Lee's work forecasts the future burden of diseases and how sound health policies can mitigate their impact on individuals and communities. Her latest research, focused on optimizing the timing of seasonal influenza vaccine selections, exemplifies the power of interdisciplinary and international collaboration by bringing together global experts in decision science, epidemiology, and clinical medicine.

Noémi Kreif adds another dimension to CHOICE's evolving research landscape by combining causal inference and machine learning to improve health policy and economic evaluations. Her work focuses on using healthcare data in flexible, equitable ways to inform personalized decision-making. She is also deeply committed to training the next generation of graduate students and researchers.

CHOICE's impact is felt not only through its research, but also in the experiences of the students who shape and are shaped by the program. Current PhD students Karris Jeon, Carlos Pineda-Antunez, and Satoshi Koiso share what drew them to CHOICE — and what makes it stand out. Jeon shared, "As someone who came to the U.S. for a PhD program, CHOICE has been a gateway to new and diverse ideas — and a community of kind, brilliant people, where purpose meets possibility."

Koiso added, "I chose CHOICE because of its close-knit community, the diversity of its students and faculty, and its strong commitment to impactful research that contributes to society. This combination of a supportive environment and meaningful work felt unique compared to other programs." And for Pineda-Antunez, the decision was simple: "Once I made my choice, I loved my CHOICE!"

Together, this new generation is exploring the intersection of economics, innovative methods, equity, and human behavior — expanding the scope of CHOICE while upholding its enduring mission. As Li puts it, "This is where ideas grow — and where people support each other in making them better."

Looking Forward

As the institute marks its 30th anniversary, its legacy is clear. Not only in the research it produces or the policies it informs — but in the people it has trained, the questions it has asked, and the values it has carried forward. Basu is clear-eyed about what lies ahead for the institute. "Healthcare inefficiencies aren't going away. The pressure to improve outcomes and control costs will only grow. And CHOICE is uniquely positioned to contribute to that conversation, both nationally and globally."

And as for what makes it all worth it?

"Coming to work every day with people who care deeply, who challenge you, who make your ideas better — that's what CHOICE is," Basu said. "And that's why it matters."





TOP RIGHT: 2012 PORPP GRADUATION; BOTTOM: CHOICE ANNUAL RETREAT, MAY 2023.

BETH DEVINE ELECTED AS PRESIDENT-ELECT OF ISPOR:
A LEGACY OF MENTORSHIP, VISION, AND SCIENTIFIC RIGOR

We are thrilled to share the exciting news that Professor Beth Devine has been elected President-Elect of ISPOR – The Professional Society for Health Economics and Outcomes Research (HEOR). Beth is Professor Emerita at the CHOICE Institute. She holds an Honorary Professorship at the University of Murcia in Spain and a Visiting Professorship at the University of Bristol in the United Kingdom (2024-2025). Beth's election to this prestigious leadership role continues the distinguished tradition of CHOICE faculty guiding ISPOR, following in the footsteps of Sean Sullivan, Lou Garrison, Scott Ramsey, Dan Malone, Shelby Reed, and Jens Grueger.

Beth's journey in healthcare and HEOR is a story of lifelong learning, mentorship, and transformative leadership. After earning her Doctor of Pharmacy degree from the University of the Pacific, she embarked on a career focused on advancing pharmacy practice. She held leadership positions in the California Society of Health-System Pharmacists (CSHP) and the American Society of Health-System Pharmacists, where she championed policies that expanded pharmacists' scope of practice. Her outstanding contributions earned her CSHP's "Pharmacist of the Year" lifetime achievement award.

Beth's passion for evidence-based healthcare led her to the University of California, San Francisco, where she chaired the Health Technology Assessment (HTA; Pharmacy & Therapeutics) Committee. This role sparked her enduring interest in HEOR, and she subsequently pursued a post-doctoral fellowship at CHOICE, including a year at Roche Pharma Business. She joined the CHOICE faculty in 2001 and has been a cornerstone of the program ever since.

With a PhD in Health Services Research from the University of Washington and over 170 peer-reviewed publications, Beth's scientific work focuses on quantitative evidence synthesis, precision medicine, preference assessment, and outcomes research. An early adopter of network meta-analysis to strengthen HTA appraisals, she served on the ISPOR Task Force on Indirect Treatment Comparisons and co-authored the associated Value in Health publication. Her research has been supported by the Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality, the National Human Genome Research Institute, the National Cancer Institute, and numerous industry partners.

Beth's early research bridged the field of medication safety to electronic health records, where she conducted the first large retrospective cohort study in the community health-system setting that estimated the impact of computerized prescriber order entry on medication errors and adverse drug events. Her interest in using electronic health record data has evolved into her commitment to the use of real-world data. As precision medicine came to the fore, she applied her passion for medication safety to the field of pharmacogenomics. Her lead editorial role for the textbook "Clinical Decision Support for Pharmacogenomic Precision Medicine," reflects her pioneering work in translating pharmacogenomics into clinical practice. Her vision for the future of HEOR emphasizes the integration of emerging data science methodologies to support more robust and actionable decision-making across healthcare contexts.

Beth's impact as an educator and mentor is equally profound. She has taught graduate-level courses in Meta-analysis, Outcomes Research Methods, and Introduction to Biostatistics and Epidemiology for PharmD students. She served as Graduate Program Director at CHOICE and led the UW-CHOICE AbbVie (legacy Allergan) post-PharmD fellowship for 12 years. Her dedication to mentorship has helped numerous students launch successful careers in HEOR. Beth's early and ongoing CHOICE collaborator and former Dean of the UW School of Pharmacy, Sean Sullivan, enthusiastically reports, "Beth is passionate about the science of HEOR, and this passion is infectious. Her graduate students frequently comment on how Beth has instilled in them a drive to succeed."

Jan Hansen, a long-time collaborator and a past President of ISPOR, reflects on Beth's mentorship and leadership: "I first had the opportunity to get to know and work with Beth during numerous fellowship programs with UW (e.g., Allergan, Genentech), where Beth served as the key faculty member/mentor guiding Fellows through their coursework, special projects, and masters' theses. The training and support Beth offered these students was invaluable, as she ensured they appropriately focused on receiving critical technical foundation, training, and skills. Still, she also instilled in them the importance of viewing the work strategically and through the eyes of the sponsor (industry) company. This ensured that the research performed by the Fellows was both scientifically rigorous and relevant from a life sciences perspective!"

Beth's legacy of mentorship is echoed by Julia Slejko, an Associate Professor in the Department of Practice, Sciences, and Health Outcomes Research (P-SHOR) at the University of Maryland School of Pharmacy, and a CHOICE alum, who said, "Beth is known as a longstanding mentor to graduate and pharmacy students pursuing careers in HEOR. Since I met Beth during my training at CHOICE over 10 years ago, I've recognized her commitment to growing the next generation of HEOR experts. I particularly value Beth's past service to ISPOR, including her role as past ISPOR Student Chapter Faculty



Advisor at UW. This commitment to the next generation and her ability to speak to a global HEOR audience reflect key facets of her vision."

Jae Lee, Associate Director at AbbVie, who worked closely with Beth on the UW/AbbVie fellowship program, adds: "I have been honored to work with Prof. Beth Devine as her mentee and colleague for the UW/AbbVie fellowship program. The long-lasting success of our fellowship program can be directly attributed to her ability to foster a nurturing environment for her students. Her passion for HEOR and work ethic have inspired numerous colleagues and students, and we are excited to see her future impact at ISPOR!"

Mark Bounthavong, a CHOICE alum and a Professor of Clinical Pharmacy at UC San Diego Skaggs School of Pharmacy & Pharmaceutical Sciences, also shares a deeply personal reflection: "Beth is a remarkable mentor and advisor. She has provided me with invaluable support and advice throughout my career. Our relationship evolved from mentor/mentee to one of lifelong friendship. Now we trade book recommendations and discuss our adventures as though we were still back at her campus office. I believe Beth will bring that level of relationship building to ISPOR and lead it to new adventures in the upcoming year."

Beth's service to ISPOR has been both broad and deep. She recently completed a term on the ISPOR Board of Directors (2021-2024) and continues to serve as an Associate Editor for Value in Health. She has led multiple workshops and co-authored the upcoming ISPOR HEOR Competency Framework revision. In 2021, she received ISPOR's HEOR Excellence in Application Award for innovative work using real-world evidence to support formulary decision-making. From 2013 to 2019, she served on the Advisory Panel of the PhRMA Foundation's Comparative Effectiveness Research Initiative. She is also an elected Society for Research Synthesis Methodology member and a former Fulbright US Scholar to Spain.

Jan Hansen offers further insight into Beth's service mindset: "I have also sat alongside Beth at ISPOR Board meetings, where we served together as Directors (and later, when I served as President and a Board special advisor). Beth consistently kept ISPOR members' needs 'front and center' as she contemplated what was in their best interests. Beth was an engaged ISPOR Board member, and conscientiously, but actively, asked questions, and voiced her opinions, again, in the spirit of 'what would drive ISPOR forward,' and 'what would serve members best.' I should also mention that during my role as ISPOR President, Beth frequently provided me with unsolicited support and validation - she was a constant 'cheerleader!' I doubt that she knows how much that meant to me - it truly 'kept me going,' as we all navigated our way through the COVID-19 pandemic together."

Lou Garrison, who has known Beth for over 25 years, sums up her impact and promise: "ISPOR and all HEOR professionals are extremely fortunate that our dear colleague Professor Emeritus Beth Devine will be helping to steer our professional scientific endeavors over the next three years. I have had the privilege of knowing and working with her for the past 25 years: few in our field have the breadth of experience, have made the varied contributions, and have demonstrated this level of commitment. ISPOR has evolved into an amazing organization due to the vision of leaders like Beth: she will undoubtedly carry on that tradition."

Anirban Basu, the Director of the CHOICE Institute, adds, "Beth exemplifies the spirit of a true academic—curious, ever-evolving, and deeply committed to learning throughout her life. We are profoundly grateful for her unwavering dedication and invaluable contributions to the CHOICE Institute over the years. It is hard to imagine a more fitting leader to guide the largest professional society in our field."

Rob Abbott, ISPOR CEO and Executive Director added: "I'm so happy for Beth on her success in becoming ISPOR President-Elect because I know how passionate she is about leveraging health economics and outcomes research (HEOR) to improve healthcare decision making. She brings a rare skill set to ISPOR, being trained in both health services research and health economics, and her commitment to scientific rigor will be a hallmark of her presidency, I'm sure." As Beth begins her role as President-Elect, she is deeply honored and excited to guide the Society in executing the ISPOR 2030 Strategic Plan and leading the global HEOR community through "Embracing the Challenge, Advancing the Science." With her steadfast commitment to mentorship, her vision for data-driven innovation, and her heartfelt care for the HEOR community, there is no doubt that ISPOR is in outstanding hands.

CHOICE HOSTS **WPEC 2025**

The 2025 Western PharmacoEconomics Conference (WPEC), hosted by the CHOICE Institute, brought together students, faculty, and industry professionals in health economics and outcomes research from across Western North America. Held in person from March 31 to April 2 on the UW campus, this biennial student-focused event provided a venue to share research, exchange ideas, and foster new collaborations. The conference featured a program that included a poster hall, podium presentations, interdisciplinary keynote panels, industry and academic roundtables, career sessions, hands-on workshops, and a memorable offsite social event on the Seattle waterfront.

WPEC 2025 facilitated opportunities for early-career researchers to showcase their work and connect with peers and mentors, while also offering sessions focused on emerging trends and challenges in the discipline. Through its diverse agenda and collaborative spirit, WPEC 2025 reinforced the CHOICE Institute's commitment to leadership and innovation in HEOR.

We would like to congratulate the following students, who won the awards for best podium presentations:

- **Drishti Baid,** University of Southern California: Implications of Prospect Theory for Consumers' Valuation of Novel Health Technologies
- **Zizi Elsisi**, University of Washington: Hepatitis C Elimination via Subscription-Based Payment Models: A Synthetic Control Study from Washington and Louisiana
- **Suning Zhao,** University of Southern California: Measuring the spillover effect of cancer on family members' health: A US-based Empirical Analysis

And the follow students, who won the awards for best posters:

- **Felipe Montano-Campos**, University of Washington: Characterizing Risk Compensation Behaviors During COVID-19: The Role of Private Preventive Measures and Risk Perceptions
- **Rahul Mudumba,** University of Southern California: Utility Over Multiple Health Indexes in Non-Small Cell Lung Cancer: Survey Estimates for Patient-Centered Generalized Risk-Adjusted Cost-Effectiveness (GRACE)
- **Maitreyi Sahu,** University of Washington: Prescription Drug Utilization and Spending by Race, Ethnicity, Payer, Health Condition, and US State

We recognize the contributions of our dedicated members of the event organizing committees:

Doug Barthold, Dave Veenstra, Anirban Basu, Josh Carlson, Marina Gano, Emily Callen, Karris Jeon, Tori Dayer, Tom Hopkins, Olivia Yip, Smriti Patil, & Leana de la Torre.

Lastly, we thank our generous sponsors, without whom this event would not have been possible:

- **Platinum sponsors:** AbbVie, Alexion, Pfizer
- **Gold sponsors:** Novartis
- **Silver sponsors:** Genentech, National Pharmaceutical Council, PhRMA
- **Bronze sponsors:** ISPOR, Novo Nordisk

TOM HOPKINS MODERATES OUR WPEC INDUSTRY CAREER PANEL.



HUI-HSUAN CHAN PODIUM PRESENTATION.



UPDATES FROM THE **UW STUDENT ISPOR CHAPTER**

The ISPOR student chapter at CHOICE held its first meeting of the year in October, led by President Manpreet Dhankhar and newly appointed Faculty Advisor Dr. Noémi Kreif. During the meeting, current PhD students and MS fellows were introduced to the chapter's mission and activities. We also welcomed our new board members:

- **Vice-President: Preetika Banerjee**
- **Treasurer: Zilin Cheng**
- **Secretary: Divya Jain**

We were thrilled to have Dr. Kreif join us as our new chapter advisor and are grateful for her support and guidance.

In preparation for ISPOR 2025 abstract submissions, the chapter hosted an Abstract Review Session on December 2. Students were invited to bring draft abstracts or ideas for feedback and discussion. Dr. Zizi Elsisi and Dr. Noémi Kreif provided helpful input on writing and submission strategies, creating a supportive space for peer review and mentorship.

In Spring, we focused on professional development and community building. Highlights included:

- ISPOR-AMCP Happy Hour (February): A collaborative event with the AMCP chapter that brought together students for an evening of networking, informal discussions, and a double-elimination Skee-Ball Tournament.
- HEOR Industry Career Workshop (April): We hosted Nina Hill, who shared valuable insights on careers in market access and outcomes research, offering practical advice and answering student questions.
- ISPOR 2024 Support: We provided $1,000 in travel support to three students — Divya Jain, HuiHsuan Chan, and Jean Lee — to attend ISPOR 2024 and engage with the broader HEOR community.

LOOKING AHEAD

As we plan for the next academic year, our vision is to expand the chapter's reach through more student-led initiatives, strengthen industry engagement, and support greater attendance and participation in HEOR conferences and workshops. We also aim to foster more collaborative programming with other student organizations.

SHELLY GRAY NAMED 2025 FULBRIGHT SCHOLAR



Congratulations to CHOICE faculty member and Plein Center for Aging Director Shelly Gray for being named a 2025 Fulbright Scholar. Fulbright Scholars are college and university faculty, administrators and researchers, as well as artists and professionals, who build their skills and connections, gain valuable international insights, and return home to share their experiences with their students and colleagues.

As one of four UW researchers selected for this prestigious award, Shelly will be hosted by China Medical University (Taiwan)'s College of Pharmacy in September. She will pursue a project titled, "Adverse drug effects of medication use on sedentary time and physical activity in older adults."

"I'm deeply honored to have been named a Fulbright Scholar and am excited to spend six months in Taiwan researching medication safety among older adults," said Shelly. "During my time there, I look forward to collaborating with Taiwanese researchers and clinicians amid Taiwan's highly regarded healthcare landscape—famed for its universal health coverage, advanced facilities, and infrastructure for epidemiology research. I hope to enhance my research skills, develop cross cultural perspectives on medication safety, and forge lifelong international partnerships that will inform my future work in healthy aging."

The Fulbright Scholar Program for academics and professionals awards more than 1,700 fellowships each year, enabling 800 U.S. scholars to go abroad and 900 visiting scholars to come to the United States. The Fulbright Program is the flagship international exchange program sponsored by the U.S. government. The UW is one of 17 institutions nationwide recognized in 2022-2023 as a "Top Producer" for both Fulbright scholars and students.

Read more about the 2025 Fulbright Scholars: https://www.washington.edu/news/2025/06/30/four-uw-researchers-named-fulbright-scholars/

ONLINE CERTIFICATE PROGRAMS UPDATE

The CHOICE Institute offers two online certificates designed to help working professionals advance their skills in health economics and outcomes research. These programs cover a wide range of topics in HEOR, with asynchronous, self-paced courses that allow for maximum flexibility.

CERTIFICATE IN DATA SCIENCE IN HEALTH ECONOMICS & OUTCOMES RESEARCH

Launched in autumn 2024, the Certificate in Data Science in Health Economics and Outcomes Research provides a comprehensive look at data science concepts and how they apply to HEOR. This training is unique in its focus on data science concepts and their application to healthcare data analysis without delving into coding or complex statistical derivations. Courses cover fundamentals including working with real-world data, causal inference methods, and machine learning methods, all applied to HEOR.

This program is ideal for professionals in the biomedical industry who have had limited exposure to statistical, econometric, and modern machine learning methods but whose work requires a deeper understanding to manage data science projects, including HEOR directors, product managers, market access directors, graduate-level researchers, and real-world evidence team members.

"The certificate provided me with a valuable foundation in machine learning (ML) methods, which have a wide range of applications to my professional work in real-world evidence (RWE) and causal inference. I enjoyed the opportunity to connect with the faculty members, who have deep expertise in HEOR and ML. I highly recommend this course to HEOR scientists looking to broaden their data science skillset."

- Kalyani Hawaldar, MS, BIOSTATISTICIAN, CERTIFICATE IN DATA SCIENCE IN HEOR 2025

THIS 9-MONTH PROGRAM OFFERS ONE COURSE PER ACADEMIC QUARTER:

FALL QUARTER:
Principles of Data Science & Health Care Data, taught by Dr. Beth Devine

WINTER QUARTER:
Comparative Effectiveness Analysis with Routine Care Data, taught by Dr. Anirban Basu

SPRING QUARTER:
Principles of Machine Learning & Applications in Health Economics & Outcomes Research, taught by Dr. Aasthaa Bansal and Dr. Noémi Kreif.

Courses include recorded lectures, readings, discussion activities, quizzes, individual capstone projects, and opportunities to connect virtually with faculty and peers in optional group meetings.

CERTIFICATE IN HEALTH ECONOMICS & OUTCOMES RESEARCH

Entering its 14th year, our Certificate in Health Economics and Outcomes Research continues to be a highly regarded program for working professionals seeking to learn more about HEOR. It provides a foundational introduction to health economics, technology assessment, and market access. Students learn how to use the tools of health economics, outcomes research, decision science, and HTA to address global market access challenges for medical technologies.

The program has trained over 600 professionals from a wide range of health care and medical technology settings, including pharmaceutical and biomedical industries, payer organizations, health insurance companies, and government agencies. Students have enrolled from all around the U.S. and from over 30 countries. Courses are continually updated to incorporate changing technologies, economies, and policy.

Applications

Applications are accepted from mid-April through early September. Courses start in late September. For more information, visit our program websites.

Certificate in Data Science in Health Economics and Outcomes Research:

https://www.pce.uw.edu/certificates/data-science-health-economics-outcomes-research

Certificate in Health Economics and Outcomes Research:
https://www.pce.uw.edu/certificates/health-economics-and-outcomes-research

Questions? Contact Leana de la Torre, Online Certificate Program Manager, at torre@uw.edu or UW Professional & Continuing Education at enroll@pce.uw.edu

THIS 9-MONTH PROGRAM OFFERS ONE COURSE PER ACADEMIC QUARTER:

FALL QUARTER:
Principles of Health Economics, taught by Dr. Lou Garrison and Dr. Douglas Barthold

WINTER QUARTER:
Economic Evaluation in Health and Medicine, taught by Dr. David Veenstra and Dr. Josh Carlson

SPRING QUARTER:
Global Health Technology Assessment & Market Access, taught by Dr. Sean Sullivan and Dr. Beth Devine

Courses include recorded lectures, readings, discussion activities, quizzes, opportunities to connect virtually with faculty and peers in optional group meetings, plus a group capstone project in which students apply their learning to an assigned country.

"The Health Economics and Outcomes Research Certificate Program at the University of Washington was a fantastic learning experience. It provided me with a strong foundation in economic evaluation, cost-effectiveness, and outcomes research, as well as supportive instructors who helped me apply my learning in real-world settings to improve healthcare decision-making. This program, along with the professional connections I've made throughout, helps me stay competitive in the rapidly changing and ever-complex US Healthcare System. I recommend it to any health leader seeking to push the bounds of affordability, access, and impact."

- **Sarah G. Potter, M.P.A.,** CERTIFICATE IN HEOR 2025

THE CAB-SUPPORTED 2024-2026 HEALTH TECH FUND PROJECTS **TACKLE THE COMPLEXITIES OF THE INFLATION REDUCTION ACT AND MEDICARE DRUG PRICE NEGOTIATION PROGRAM**



The Inflation Reduction Act (IRA) of 2022 created multiple changes to the Medicare prescription drug benefit program. The three major policy reforms included: (1) limits on annual drug price increases to prevent them from outpacing inflation; (2) a major redesign of the Part D drug benefit, including a $2,000 annual cap on beneficiaries' out-of-pocket drug costs starting in 2025, with annual updates thereafter; and (3) modifications to the manufacturer discount program. Most importantly, Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) was given authority to select and directly negotiate with industry the prices for a limited number of drugs each year. This new authority removed a restriction contained in the 2004 law that created the Part D program that prohibited CMS from directly negotiating drug prices with the pharmaceutical industry.

The current Health Tech Fund projects, supported by a consortium of 15 pharmaceutical companies, provide research funding and direct graduate student support to evaluate several of the policy reforms created by the IRA. One line of research tackles the impact of the first and second rounds of drug price negotiation on federal spending and beneficiary out-of-pocket costs. Other research includes identifying Part B drugs and forecasting prices for the third round of negotiation. The third round of negotiation involves injected or infused biologics given in outpatient or clinic settings. CMS negotiation for the Part B drugs will involve a more complex set of price benchmarks and evidence assessments as compared to Part D outpatient drugs. This work is directed by Professor Sean D. Sullivan and supported by two senior PhD students, Emma Cousin, PharmD, and Karris Jeon, BSN, MSc. The CHOICE research team is joined by Kristi Martin, MPA, former Chief of Staff at the Center for Medicare and Nico Garbiel, MA, research analyst at the University of California, San Diego.







ABOVE: HEALTH TECH FUND RESEARCH TEAM- KARRIS JEON, EMMA COUSIN, SEAN D. SULLIVAN.

CHOICE RESEARCH FINDS MARKETING PAYMENTS TO PHYSICIANS BY CANCER DRUG COMPANIES INCREASE DRUG EXPENDITURES WITHOUT IMPROVING PATIENT MORTALITY



A recent publication by Dr. Jing Li, Associate Professor of Health Economics and Associate Director of The CHOICE Institute, in collaboration with co-authors from Cornell University examined the impact of direct-to-physician marketing payments from cancer drug companies on Medicare prescribing expenditures and patient mortality.

This article is published in the Journal of Public Economics, ranked in the top 10 of general Economics journals. The research is funded by the National Institute of Aging and the National Institute of Health Care Management.

Nearly 500 cancer drugs were approved over the past decade. Many of these drugs have high prices and small survival benefits. However, pharmaceutical companies often employ marketing activities involving financial payments to educate physicians about the clinical evidence for new therapies or new indications — a practice that has long been viewed as problematic due to the potential undue influence that may sway prescribing decisions.

Using Open Payments Data and Medicare Part B claims data, this research uncovers a compelling trend: once physicians and cancer drug companies engage in a financial relationship — namely, when physicians accept marketing payments from pharmaceutical firms — Medicare spending accelerates and prescribing increases without improving patient mortality.

Of the physicians considered in this study, 67% received at least one marketing payment related to cancer treatment between 2014 and 2018. Major drugs such as Opdivo® and Keytruda® reach more than half of prescribers with financial incentives like these.

Upon receiving payment from a drug company, physician prescribing of the associated drug increased 4% in the following year, accelerating Part B cancer drug expenditure.

Further, physicians are found to begin treating cancer patients with lower predicted mortality--that is, expanding the incentivized drug treatment to healthier patients with little meaningful improvement.

Based on the findings, marketing activities yield a rate of return of over 800% for cancer drug manufacturers. On the other hand, the increase in drug expenditure induced by the marketing encounters yields mostly negative incremental cost effectiveness ratio (ICER), with the lowest ICER estimates being above $100,000/QALY, suggesting that marketing payments lead to changes in prescribing that might not be cost-effective even at the lower bounds of the mortality estimates.

Carey C, Daly M, Li J. Nothing for Something: Marketing Cancer Drugs to Physicians Increases Prescribing Without Improving Mortality. Journal of public economics. 2025 February; 242:105311. **https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S004727272500009X**

> **"The study provides rigorous causal evidence on the consequences of marketing payments to physicians from cancer drug companies, indicating strongly that such payments may not add value to the quality of cancer care and patient outcomes."**
>
> - JING LI, ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR

LEE RECEIVES GRANT TO EXAMINE POTENTIAL BENEFITS OF DELAYING SEASONAL INFLUENZA VACCINE SELECTIONS

CHOICE Assistant Professor Kyueun Lee and her collaborators received a 2025 Global Innovation Fund Tier 2 Research Award. The project is titled, "The Potential Benefits of Delaying Seasonal Influenza Vaccine Selections for the Southern Hemisphere: A Retrospective Modeling Study in Australia."



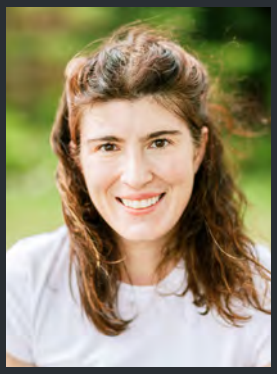
Antigenic similarity between vaccine viruses and circulating viruses is crucial for achieving high vaccine effectiveness against seasonal influenza. Currently, the World Health Organization selects vaccine strains for the Northern and Southern Hemispheres six months before the influenza season begins, compromising antigenic similarity. Although new vaccine technologies have the potential to revise this schedule, their epidemiological benefits are unknown. In her previous study published in the Journal of Infectious Diseases, Dr. Lee demonstrated that revising the vaccine strain selection timeline for the Northern Hemisphere could have substantially reduced the influenza burden in the past seasons. However, the Southern Hemisphere has distinct patterns of influenza evolution and seasonality, thus potential benefits of delayed vaccine strain selection may differ from those in the Northern Hemisphere.

This study will analyze viral activity data in Southern Hemisphere influenza surveillance and apply a simulation model of influenza in Australia to: 1) identify past influenza seasons that would have benefited from delayed vaccine strain selection in the Southern Hemisphere, and 2) quantify the epidemiological impact of such delays. Additionally, the team will compare the benefits estimated in Australia with those previously estimated for the United States, providing a cross-hemispheric perspective on the potential value of revising global vaccine strain selection timelines.

This study leverages interdisciplinary and global collaboration, integrating expertise in decision science, epidemiology, and clinical medicine. Dr. Lee will collaborate with Professor Janet Englund at Seattle Children's Hospital, a renowned expert in influenza vaccine policy. Dr. Lee will also work closely with Professor Sheena Sullivan, formerly of the WHO Collaborating Center in Melbourne, Australia, who will provide access to key data on influenza antigenic characterization and influenza virus surveillance data in Australia. A CHOICE PhD student, Manpreet Dhankhar, will support the project as a research assistant contributing to data analysis and modeling efforts.

> **"Influenza remains difficult to control, with vaccine effectiveness often suboptimal due to the uncertainty of viral evolution. This challenge leads to highly variable outcomes across seasons. Enhancing surveillance to detect viral changes earlier could support better-informed vaccine decisions and offer valuable insights to decision makers and manufacturers on improving the current selection schedule."**
>
> - KYU LEE, PHD, ASSISTANT PROFESSOR

MACHINE LEARNING FOR INDIVIDUALIZED TREATMENT EFFECTS: **OPPORTUNITIES AND CHALLENGES**



Understanding how patients respond differently to medical treatments is a growing priority in HEOR. In a recent scoping review published in Medical Decision Making, Assistant Professor Noémi Kreif and colleagues from the University of York examine how machine learning (ML) methods are advancing the estimation of individualized, or heterogeneous, treatment effects. Unlike traditional predictive ML, the causal ML approaches covered in the review aim to estimate what would happen to a patient both with and without a treatment—information crucial for tailoring care and informing resource allocation.

The review highlights that, with real-world observational data, confounding—differences between treated and untreated patients—poses a key challenge. Modern causal ML methods, such as Causal Forests and Bayesian Additive Regression trees, are designed to address this by flexibly modeling complex, nonlinear relationships while adjusting for confounders.

These techniques, developed across computer science, biostatistics, and economics, are increasingly being considered for HTA applications, including analyses involving longitudinal data or time-to-event outcomes. However, the review highlights that most available methods are best suited to simpler, cross-sectional datasets with continuous or binary outcomes, and many do not yet provide robust ways to quantify uncertainty in their predictions. This limitation means that careful validation and transparency are essential when applying these tools in HEOR. The authors emphasize the need for practical guidance, the use of multiple methods to check robustness, and the involvement of clinical experts to interpret findings. As ML adoption accelerates in HEOR, these considerations will be key to ensuring that new methods have the potential to improve clinical and policy decisions. Many of these topics are discussed in the CHOICE online Certificate in Data Science in HEOR.

Zhang, Y., Kreif, N., Gc, V. S., & Manca, A. (2024). Machine Learning Methods to Estimate Individualized Treatment Effects for Use in Health Technology Assessment. Medical Decision Making, 44(7), 756-769.

https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/39056320/

CHOICE RESEARCHERS EXAMINE ONCOLOGIST-PATIENT CONCORDANCE AND TREATMENT ADHERENCE IN CHRONIC MYELOID LEUKEMIA

In their new JAMA Network Open study, recent PhD graduate Felipe Montano-Campos, Professor Aasthaa Bansal, and their co-authors tracked 5 years of monthly tyrosine kinase inhibitor (TKI) adherence in chronic myeloid leukemia (CML) patients.

"After adjusting for patient and provider characteristics — including differences in oncology practice styles — we found that oncologist-patient concordance (i.e., shared identity traits) was associated with higher and more sustained adherence over time" says Felipe.

To rule out the possibility that concordant relationships were driven by patient selection or provider sorting, the team formally tested whether concordance was associated with underlying clinical, sociodemographic, or care-seeking characteristics. It was not—the association with adherence remained robust.

This is one of the first studies to isolate the long-term behavioral impact of patient-provider concordance in real-world oncology care.





A NEW MODEL OF CARE FOR MEDICATIONS FOR **OPIOID USE DISORDER MAINTENANCE AT COMMUNITY PHARMACIES**







A team of School of Pharmacy faculty researchers received a $200,000 Tier 3 pilot research grant from the UW Population Health Initiative. Their project was one of only four selected in a highly competitive funding round, which distributed nearly $900,000 to support innovative, cross-disciplinary research addressing urgent public health challenges.

The interdisciplinary team includes Dr. Clayton English, Dr. Ryan Hansen, Dr. Jenny Bacci, and SOP alumna Dr. Jenny Arnold. The research team also includes Dr. Anthony Floyd (Department of Psychiatry and Behavioral Sciences) and Boris Zhang (Washington State Pharmacy Association). They will work closely with community partners CPESN WA and ScalaNW.

The team's research addresses the growing opioid overdose crisis in Washington State, where fentanyl-related deaths continue to rise. Despite the urgency, access to medications for opioid use disorder (MOUD) remains inconsistent, particularly in underserved areas. With recent regulatory changes expanding pharmacists' authority to prescribe MOUD, community pharmacies are emerging as critical access points for treatment.

This pilot study will evaluate both the implementation and effectiveness of a new MOUD maintenance model in three community pharmacies across Washington. The project will leverage partnerships with ScalaNW and CPESN WA to support provider handoffs, academic detailing, and technical assistance. Using the RE-AIM framework, the team will assess implementation outcomes through surveys, interviews, and site visits, while analyzing dispensing data to understand prescribing patterns and continuity of care.

Ultimately, the project aims to demonstrate a scalable, pharmacy-based model of care that can improve access to treatment, reduce overdose rates, and promote health equity across the state.

> **"Opioid use disorder continues to be a public health crisis, and one that pharmacists are perfectly suited to be active in addressing on the front lines of community pharmacies. This pilot will provide important evidence that we will be able to use as leverage with pharmacy managers and decision makers to expand harm reduction treatment in our communities"**
>
> - RYAN HANSEN, PHARMD, PHD, PROFESSOR & CHAIR, DEPARTMENT OF PHARMACY

UW/ICER COLLABORATION UPDATE **2025**







In 2016, The CHOICE Institute and the Institute for Clinical and Economic Review (ICER) formed a partnership establishing the first multi review academic site. This relationship has continued for 9 years and 5 additional contracts. The current team comprises of Professor Josh Carlson (PI), Linda Luu (research scientist/lead modeler), Kangho Suh (lead modeler) an Assistant Professor at the University of Pittsburg and a CHOICE alumnus, and 3rd year PhD Student, Hui-Hsuan Chan.

To date the UW-ICER team has collaborated on economic evaluations for 27 topics. This work has been disseminated at ICER public meetings, as part of ICER's full topic reports, in conference proceedings (9 abstracts), and in peer-reviewed journals (19 published).

In recent evaluations, they performed a review of treatments for Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD) (Breo Ellipta® and Trelegy Ellipta®) as part of a Special Assessment to Inform Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) Drug Price Negotiation and imetelstat for Anemia in Myelodysplastic Syndrome. In the COPD report, the team found that both treatments resulted in fewer exacerbations, increased life years, increased equal value of life years (evLYs) gained, and higher non-intervention health care sector costs vs. generic alternatives. However, the differences were relatively minor, especially for Breo Elllipta®. In the imetelstat evaluation, they found that imetelstat patients experienced small gains in quality-adjusted life years, evLYs, and life years, and a reduction in total red blood cell transfusions compared to patients on best supportive care alone. However, at the current Wholesale Acquistion Cost, it would exceed commonly used cost-effectiveness thresholds.

In summary, CHOICE's collaboration with ICER continues, providing valuable research opportunities for faculty and students and contributing to timely and impactful conversations about the value of emerging products in the U.S. The team looks forward to continued collaboration with ICER and the many companies developing innovative medical products.

> **"I'm grateful for this opportunity to work with so many different stakeholders in the modeling process. In the ICER model project, I learned that it's not just about our team's internal discussions, but also about bringing in views from external experts, patients, and manufacturers. This makes the work feel more complete and fair, not only strong in methods but also respectful of different perspectives."**
>
> - HUI-HSUAN CHAN, PHD STUDENT

CHOICE/WASHINGTON RESEARCH FOUNDATION EARLY HEALTH TECHNOLOGY ASSESSMENT (HTA) FELLOWSHIP UPDATE

HTA has been a key strength of The CHOICE Institute over the course of the past 30 years. Our faculty, staff, and graduate students have participated in a variety of activities to push the science of HTA into the future. The CHOICE Institute and the Washington Research Foundation (WRF) established an ongoing fellowship in 2018 under the initial guidance of Affiliate Associate Professor Dr. Lotte Steuten, now Deputy Chief Executive, Office of Health Economics, London and leadership of Affiliate Assistant Professor Dr. Will Canestaro, former Managing Director of WRF and current Entrepreneur in Residence at Pioneer Square Labs. The fellowship is currently led by CHOICE faculty member, Ryan Hansen as well as Clarisse Benson & Meher Antia from WRF. CHOICE graduate student Carlos Pineda-Antunez most recently served as the fellowship research assistant for the past academic year where he completed four projects and built an early-stage cost-effectiveness in R model template that will be accessible for future fellows.

Each CHOICE/WRF fellowship project involves pairing a graduate student with prerequisite training in cost-effectiveness modeling and a principal investigator (PI) who has funding from WRF to develop a new health technology. These PIs are identified from WRF's portfolio as developers who are at a key decision-making phase of development where HTA methods may be applied to answer important questions. The projects involve scoping of the question(s) and preparing a modeling analysis plan, building an HTA model appropriate for the question(s) of interest, and then preparing a written report and presentation. These reports are disseminated to the PIs and their teams, as well as the WRF team to inform future growth and funding priorities. Over seven years, this fellowship has provided opportunities for 19 graduate students, several with multiple projects, to polish their decision modeling skills by applying them to early-stage health technology assessment questions.

Recent CHOICE Alumnus Dr. Zizi Elsisi served as the graduate research assistant for this fellowship over two years, and among her many projects recently published a manuscript with Drs. Steuten, Canestaro, and Hansen titled "Applying Early Health Technology Assessment (e-HTA) to Inform Investment in Novel Health Technologies in the US" in the International Journal of Technology Assessment in Health Care. This manuscript provides a comprehensive review of the first 10 fellowship projects to describe how those student-led projects helped to "guide the development and positioning of emerging health innovations" and offers the first published systematic evaluation of e-HTA activity in the US.

We wish to thank the WRF for this partnership. The WRF recently renewed its support for this important fellowship program for another two years, solidifying this ongoing opportunity for collaboration between our faculty, students, and health care technology developers in Washington State.







RYAN HANSEN, CARLOS PINEDA, AND ZIZI ELSISI

CHOICE RESEARCHERS EXPLORE LINK BETWEEN PHARMACY VACCINES AND MISSED PEDIATRIC VISITS

Can pharmacists improve childhood vaccination rates without disrupting well-child visits? The latest research looks promising according to CHOICE PhD student Shiven Bhardwaj and Dr. Jennifer Bacci, Endowed Associate Professor in Innovative Pharmacy Practice. In collaboration with colleagues at Fred Hutchinson Cancer Center and the University of Pittsburgh School of Pharmacy, Bhardwaj and Bacci co-authored a study that addresses a common concern:



Would allowing pharmacists to vaccinate children result in more delayed or missed well-child visits?

The study found that commercially insured children who received vaccinations at a pharmacy were just as likely – if not more likely – to attend their well-child visits on time due to easier access to pharmacies in community retail settings that are part of day-to-day activities of families.

While pharmacists in Washington State have been vaccinating children for over 40 years, many states still prohibit them from doing so.



The research from Bhardwaj and Bacci provides fundamental evidence to support the expansion of pharmacy-based immunization services, reinforcing the role of pharmacists as key healthcare providers in ensuring timely and equitable access to pediatric care. By breaking down barriers to vaccination, Bacci, Bhardwaj, and their colleagues are paving the way for more accessible, innovative, community-driven solutions to transform pharmacy practice.

Bhardwaj S, Galanter N, Berenbrok LA, Shah PD, Bacci JL. Pediatric vaccination in pharmacies is not associated with delayed well-child visits among commercially insured children. Health Aff Sch. 2025 Feb 10;3(2):qxaf028. doi: 10.1093/haschl/qxaf028. PMID: 39974149; PMCID: PMC11837177.

https://academic.oup.com/healthaffairsscholar/article/3/2/qxaf028/8006548?login=false



BACCI MODERATES A POSTER SESSION AT THE NASEM INNOVATIONS IN PHARMACY PRACTICE WORKSHOP, WASHINGTON DC.

2025 RECIPIENTS OF THE **LOUIS SR. AND MARILYN GARRISON ENDOWED PRIZE IN HEALTH POLICY AND ECONOMICS**

On behalf of Professor Emeritus Lou Garrison and his wife Fran, we are pleased to announce the two winners of the 2025 Louis Sr. and Marilyn Garrison Endowed Prize in Health Policy and Economics. Lou and Fran established this award in 2005 in memory of his parents who — despite never having attended college — were strong supporters of higher education for Lou and his two sisters as well as for everyone with that aspiration. Lou was a teaching assistant in the renowned health economist Victor Fuchs's health economics class at Stanford in 1975, so he has been at this for 50 years. He is eternally grateful to Victor (his dissertation advisor), his mentor Professor Doug Brown of Georgetown, Gail Wilensky (his boss at Project HOPE), and other mentors, colleagues, and friends who have shared and supported his interest in health policy and economics for his entire career. Lou and Fran congratulate and thank the winners — and all who submitted papers — for their efforts to address important health policy challenges facing our world.



Tori Dayer, PharmD
PhD Student

PROJECT TITLE: *Comprehensive Access to Semaglutide: Clinical and Economic Implications for Medicare*



Olivia Yip, PharmD, MS
AbbVie HEOR Fellow

PROJECT TITLE: *Cost-Utility Analysis of Academic Detailing on Naloxone Distribution Among Opioid Users in the United States*

HUI-HSUAN CHAN NAMED **2025 MAGNUSON SCHOLARS AWARD RECIPIENT**

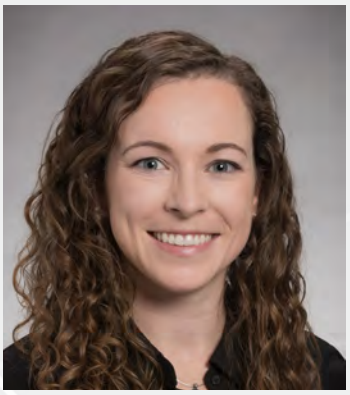


CHOICE PhD student Hui-Hsuan Chan was selected as a 2025 Magnuson Award recipient. With a keen interest in improving healthcare sustainability through robust health economics research, Hui-Hsuan focuses on managing high-cost chronic conditions like diabetes to alleviate their economic burden.

The Magnuson Scholars Award is presented annually to one outstanding student from each of the six UW Health Sciences schools: Dentistry, Medicine, Nursing, Pharmacy, Public Health, and Social Work. Funded by the Warren G. Magnuson Institute, the award recognizes academic excellence and the potential to advance impactful research in health sciences, particularly in areas such as diabetes and public health. It also provides generous financial support for continued training and research.

"I'm honored to be selected as a 2025 Magnuson Scholar representing the School of Pharmacy," Hui-Hsuan said. "This award provides generous support for my continued research into improving healthcare sustainability and managing high-cost chronic conditions like diabetes. I'm grateful for the opportunity to contribute to meaningful, lasting impact."

2025 UW SCHOOL OF PHARMACY GRADUATE STUDENT LEADERSHIP AWARD



This spring, Tori was honored with the School of Pharmacy 2025 Graduate Student Leadership Award in recognition of her lasting impact on the program and her peers. Throughout her doctoral training — both PharmD and PhD — Tori has demonstrated exceptional leadership and service to the School and the Department. She has served as President of the ISPOR Student Chapter and held multiple roles within the Student AMCP chapter, consistently advocating for student engagement and professional development.

For the past two years, Tori has also served as the Graduate Staff Assistant supporting the CHOICE MS programs. In this pioneering role, she has built essential training and administrative infrastructure that will benefit students, staff, and faculty for years to come. Reflecting on her experience, Tori shared:

"I have had the privilege of being the very first student to have this role, which means that I have gotten to shape what the role is and meet students where they are to best support them. I have taken initiative to do so, particularly in holding office hours, meeting with students individually, creating and teaching workshops for the students when I notice a common gap in understanding or knowledge, and doing my best to learn alongside them when they ask questions that I don't know the answer to."

Most recently, Tori played a key leadership role in organizing the Western PharmacoEconomics Conference, managing logistics, and helping lead the event on the day it took place. One of her nominators, Marina Gano (Graduate Program Manager), remarked: "In the weeks leading up to the conference, Tori saved the day, time and time again. Tori's professionalism, leadership, and calm positivity were key contributors to what made our event such a success, and for that, I am so grateful."

Tori's dissertation chair, Professor Sean Sullivan, echoed this sentiment: "Tori is a delightful person, always willing to pitch in and help with projects, mentor other graduate students, organize social events, and contribute to various CHOICE and Department initiatives. She is truly deserving of the School's graduate leadership award."

Tori reflected on the recognition with gratitude: "Being part of the CHOICE and School of Pharmacy community has continually inspired me to grow and collaborate. I am very honored to receive this award and to have had the opportunity to contribute to such a wonderful community!"

MANPREET DHANKHAR NAMED **2025 BONDERMAN FELLOW**



We're excited to share that Manpreet Dhankhar, a PhD student from The CHOICE Institute, has been selected as a 2025 Bonderman Fellow. Manpreet is one of just two students from the UW School of Pharmacy to have received this fellowship since its inception.

As part of the program, Manpreet will receive $26,000 to travel independently for eight months through at least two regions of the world. Fellows are encouraged to explore new places, engage with different cultures, and learn from the experience — without the structure of academic study or research.

Manpreet's travel goals are rooted in a desire to explore how craft, tradition, and identity intersect across cultures. With a background in pottery and textiles, she is particularly interested in how everyday creative practices are woven into the rhythms of daily life and how they reflect care, memory, and cultural preservation. Her current proposed itinerary includes Vietnam, Thailand, India, South Korea, Japan, Cambodia, Argentina, and Chile.

"This fellowship will allow me to immerse myself in vastly different cultures and to learn from the lived experiences, perspectives, and histories of people in other countries," Manpreet said. "As someone whose work in the School of Pharmacy is shaped by

continued on next page

MANPREET DHANKHAR NAMED **2025 BONDERMAN FELLOW (CONT'D)**

global public health questions, stepping out of my comfort zone and experiencing new perspectives firsthand will no doubt influence my research, deepen my understanding of the world, and shape who I am as a person."

The Bonderman Fellowship was established in 1995 by UW alumnus David Bonderman to support meaningful international travel for students. Since then, it has helped hundreds of Huskies broaden their horizons and reflect on their place in the world. Following Mr. Bonderman's passing in December 2024, this year's fellows continue to carry forward his vision.

"It's a very exciting opportunity, and I'm grateful for the chance to grow as I undertake this journey," Manpreet said.

Congratulations to Manpreet and we look forward to following the journey ahead!

2025 SCHOOL OF PHARMACY OUTSTANDING DISSERTATION AWARD



Zizi Elsisi, PhD ('25), has been named the recipient of the 2025 School of Pharmacy Outstanding Dissertation Award, recognizing the exceptional quality, innovation, and policy relevance of her doctoral research. Her dissertation, "Evaluating Subscription-Based Payment Models for Hepatitis C Treatment in Louisiana and Washington," explores how alternative drug pricing strategies can expand access to life-saving treatments for vulnerable populations.

Zizi's work focuses on subscription-based payment models (SBPMs) — often referred to as the "Netflix model" for drug pricing — implemented in Louisiana and Washington to improve access to direct-acting antivirals (DAAs) for Hepatitis C. Using national Medicaid claims data and advanced quasi-experimental methods, she evaluated the real-world impact of these models on screening and treatment uptake.

Her findings revealed that Louisiana's SBPM led to significant increases in HCV RNA testing and DAA initiation, while Washington's model showed minimal or negative effects. These results, consistent across demographic and geographic subgroups, underscore the importance of implementation context — such as provider engagement, infrastructure readiness, and patient education — in determining policy success.

"It's an incredible honor to receive the Outstanding Dissertation Award for my research on subscription-based payment models for hepatitis C treatment in Louisiana and Washington," Zizi said. "This work highlights how innovative financing strategies can improve access to cure medications for vulnerable populations. I'm proud to contribute to research that bridges policy and real-world impact. I'm especially grateful to my advisor, Dr. Anirban Basu, and the CHOICE Institute for their invaluable mentorship and support throughout this journey."

Dr. Basu praised the originality and rigor of her work: "Zizi's dissertation is a benchmark study for states considering subscription-based payment models as part of broader Hepatitis C elimination efforts. Her ability to tackle complex analytical challenges and translate them into actionable insights for policymakers is truly impressive."

Zizi's research is currently under review and is being presented at national conferences. Congratulations, Zizi, on this well-deserved recognition!

FIVE CHOICE STUDENTS AWARDED PLEIN CENTER FOR AGING SCHOLARSHIP

The Plein Center for Aging is a global leader in transformative pharmacy research, education, and outreach. Committed to optimizing medication outcomes for older adults and promoting healthy aging, the Center supports innovative work at the intersection of pharmacy and aging. This year, five CHOICE graduate students were awarded Plein Center scholarships — an opportunity designed to foster student engagement in aging-related research.



Preetika Banerjee
2nd year PhD Student

PROJECT TITLE: *Exploring the Relationship Between Antiviral Treatment and Antibiotic Prescribing for Respiratory Illnesses in Older Adults: A MEPS-Based Analysis*

Preetika's research focuses on the intersection of antiviral use and antibiotic prescribing in older adults with respiratory viral infections. Using nationally representative data from the Medical Expenditure Panel Survey (MEPS), Preetika will examine whether early antiviral treatment, such as Paxlovid or Tamiflu, reduces the likelihood of inappropriate antibiotic use during subsequent illness episodes. This work addresses an important gap in antimicrobial stewardship by evaluating how timely antiviral therapy may help curb unnecessary antibiotic prescribing, a key driver of antimicrobial resistance. She will also investigate which patient and provider characteristics are associated with inappropriate antibiotic use, using predictors like frailty, comorbidities, and healthcare access. The goal is to generate real-world, policy-relevant evidence to inform safer, more effective prescribing practices for older adults, a population that disproportionately experiences the harms of both infection and medication overuse.



Shiven Bhardwaj
4th year PhD Student

PROJECT TITLE: *Assessing Impact of the Inflation Reduction Act on Long Term Care Pharmacies*

Passed in 2022, the Inflation Reduction Act (IRA) includes provisions designed to lower Medicare Part D spending and improve prescription affordability. Several of these policies indirectly affect Long-Term Care (LTC) pharmacies. Shiven will systematically examine these provisions, highlighting their intended and unintended impacts on LTC pharmacies. He will also outline measures that the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) have taken to mitigate potential harms, along with additional steps needed to ensure seniors continue receiving high-quality LTC pharmacy services

STUDENTS ENJOYING THE CHERRY BLOSSOMS; CHOICE STUDENTS AND FRIENDS HAPPY HOUR.





FIVE CHOICE STUDENTS AWARDED **PLEIN CENTER FOR AGING SCHOLARSHIP** (CONTINUED)



Julia Fox
4th year PhD Student

PROJECT TITLE: *Investigating Disparities in Healthcare Utilization and Outcomes for Sexual Minority Older Adults*

Julia Fox will be leveraging Medicare claims data linked with data from the Health and Retirement Survey (HRS) to investigate differences in rates of potentially inappropriate medications, polypharmacy, medication-related problems, and adverse drug events between sexual minority older adults and heterosexual older adults. As sexual minority older adults are less likely to have family caregivers and report higher anxiety about engaging with healthcare professionals, she aims to study if those differences impact pharmaceutical utilization and pharmacological outcomes. Results will additionally be analyzed by dementia status to determine if differences are exacerbated by the condition. She is deeply grateful to the Plein Center for supporting this important research.



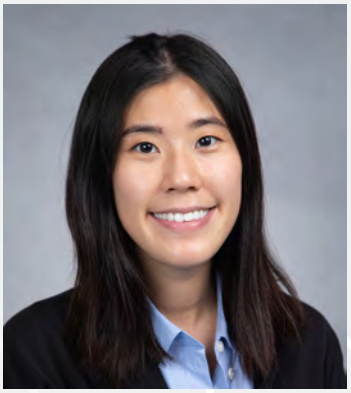
Ben Nwogu
5th year PhD Student

PROJECT TITLE: *Comparative Effectiveness of Multiple Treatments for Metastatic Hormone-Sensitive Prostate Cancer (mHSPC): A Target Trial Emulation Using Claims Data*

Ben Nwogu is addressing a critical gap in cancer care for older adults through his innovative research on novel therapies for metastatic hormone-sensitive prostate cancer (mHSPC). Leveraging rich real-world data, he expertly combines the target trial emulation framework with advanced machine learning methods to evaluate survival outcomes among patients treated with androgen deprivation therapy (ADT) in combination with abiraterone, apalutamide, enzalutamide, or docetaxel. By comparing these four treatment strategies, his study addresses an important evidence gap resulting from the absence of head-to-head randomized clinical trials directly evaluating these therapies. His findings will generate robust real-world comparative effectiveness data to support evidence-based treatment decisions by clinicians and patients, while also informing clinical guidelines and policy recommendations.







Olivia Yip
2nd Year MS Fellow

PROJECT TITLE: *Cost-Utility Analysis of Non-Prescription Oseltamivir for Influenza Treatment*

Influenza is a viral respiratory infection that causes significant morbidity and mortality in older adults. Oseltamivir, when initiated within 48 hours of symptom onset, has been shown to reduce the duration of symptoms and the risk of serious complications. However, the current requirement for a prescription can delay treatment initiation, limiting its potential benefit. With increasing availability of rapid diagnostic tests, reclassifying oseltamivir to be available without a prescription following a positive influenza test may improve timely access and utilization. To evaluate this strategy, Olivia is conducting a decision-analytic modeling assessing the cost-effectiveness of oseltamivir reclassification from both the U.S. healthcare sector and limited societal perspectives. The hope is that this work would help facilitate earlier initiation of antiviral therapy and reduce influenza-related complications, hospitalizations, and healthcare expenditures among older adults.









OPPOSITE PAGE BOTTOM LEFT: JULIA FOX PRESENTS HER WORK AT THE PLEIN CENTER FOR AGING RESEARCH SYMPOSIUM, APRIL 2025; BOTTOM RIGHT: DRS. KREIF AND LEE HOSTED A FAREWELL LUNCH FOR THEIR ADVISEES.

FROM TOP RIGHT: PREETIKA BANERJEE MODERATES THE WPEC OPENING PLENARY GIVEN BY DR. DARIUS LAKDAWALLA, UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA; MS FELLOWS WITH TORI, GRADUATE STAFF ASSISTANT; FELLOWS ON A HIKE AT MT. RAINIER, SUMMER 2024; CHOICE FACULTY, STAFF, STUDENTS, AND ALUMNI CELEBRATE THE END OF A SUCCESSFUL WPEC!

CLAYTON ENGLISH RECOGNIZED NATIONALLY FOR LEADERSHIP IN PSYCHIATRIC PHARMACY



Congratulations to Dr. Clayton English for being recently named a 2025 Fellow of the American Association of Psychiatric Pharmacists (AAPP)—a national recognition of his leadership, clinical excellence, and dedication to mental health care. In addition, Dr. English was elected President-Elect of the AAPP Foundation, where he will help guide national efforts to support psychiatric pharmacy research, education, and practitioner development.

NOÉMI KREIF JOINS KENNEDY FORUM'S ECONOMICS COMMITTEE



Dr. Kreif was invited to be a member of The Kennedy Forum's Economics Committee, also known as the "Brain Health Economics Council." The committee is made up of leaders from across sectors, coming together to help answer the critical question: Can and should public budget analysts in the U.S. account for the full economic impacts of addressing the youth mental health crisis?

DAVE VEENSTRA EXPLORES IMPACT OF POLYGENIC RISK SCORES ON PATIENT CARE



Dr. Veenstra is a member of the NIH-funded eMERGE consortium, which recently completed data collection for a 25,000-person study evaluating the potential of genomic screening using polygenic risk scores (PRS) to identify individuals at higher risk for future disease. Dr. Veenstra is leading the analysis of patient and provider actions in response to this risk information, with the eventual goal of measuring impacts on diagnoses and disease outcomes.

OPPOSITE PAGE, BOTTOM LEFT: DR. WATKINS AMCP AWARD ANNOUNCEMENT; BOTTOM RIGHT: DR. BASU ON STAGE AT ACADEMY HEALTH, JUNE 2025.

ANIRBAN BASU JOINS MULTIPLE NATIONAL BLOOD DISORDER COMMITTEES



In 2024, Dr. Basu was invited to join both the NCAA Advisory Committee for Sickle Cell Trait Screening Guidelines and the Illinois Governor's Advisory Council on Financing and Access to Sickle Cell Disease Treatment and Other High-Cost Drugs. In 2025, he was also appointed to the National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine Committee for the Strategic Plan and Blueprint to address Thalassemia in the United States.



JOHN WATKINS RECEIVES AMCP STEVEN G. AVEY AWARD

Affiliate Professor John Watkins has been honored with the AMCP Steven G. Avey Award for his exceptional contributions to managed care pharmacy. During his 22-year tenure at Premera Blue Cross, he led formulary development, launched the Value-Based Formulary, and established an ASHP-accredited residency program. A dedicated educator and national contributor, John continues to advance pharmaceutical value assessment as an independent consultant and affiliate faculty member.

PETE FULLERTON HONORED WITH AMCP NORTHWEST LIFETIME ACHIEVEMENT AWARD

Affiliate Professor Pete Fullerton has received the AMCP Northwest Lifetime Achievement Award in recognition of his impactful career in managed care, pharmacy innovation, and academic leadership. His contributions include pioneering the AMCP drug dossier format and advancing pharmacy programs at Regence Blue Shield, as well as holding leadership roles at major universities and professional organizations.





Jennifer Bacci, PharmD, MPH, BCACP

- National Academy of Medicine Fellow in Pharmacy 2024-2026
- Completed Business of Healthcare Specialization from The Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania
- Co-Investigator on the Population Health Initiative Tier 3 pilot research grant: A New Model of Care for Medications for Opioid Use Disorder Maintenance at Community Pharmacies: A Pilot Effectiveness-Implementation Study
- Served on the organizing committee for National Academy of Medicine "Innovations in Pharmacy Practice" workshop in May 2025



DR. BACCI PRESENTING AT THE NAM INNOVATIONS IN PHARMACY PRACTICE WORKSHOP.

Aasthaa Bansal, PhD

- Promoted to full Professor, July 2025
- To begin a faculty position at University of Toronto in September 2025; appointed as Affiliate Professor with UW School of Pharmacy

Douglas Barthold, PhD

- Promoted to Associate Professor, January 2025
- Appointed Associate Director of HEOR Graduate Program
- Co-Chair, Scientific Committee, 2025 Western PharmacoEconomics Conference
- Panel Speaker, WPEC, April 2025: Prescription Drug Affordability Boards – Challenges and Opportunities

Anirban Basu, PhD

- Panel speaker to discuss the foundations, tools, and frameworks around AI to improve public health. Future of AI and the Health Sciences Summit, August 2024
- Plenary Speaker at 2025 Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. Building Resilient Careers: Strategizing for Shifting Research Climates
- Co-Chair, Executive Committee, 2025 Western PharmacoEconomics Conference

Josh Carlson, PhD, MPH

- Director, Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program in Health Economics and Outcomes Research, Pfizer, 2025-2027
- ICER Economic Modeling. 01/01/2026 – 12/31/2027. Carlson (PI), Role: PI. Institute for Clinical and Economic Review. Budget: $370,000
- Co-Chair, Executive Committee, 2025 Western PharmacoEconomics Conference
- Co-led WPEC workshop, April 2025: Dynamic Pricing in Models

Beth Devine, PhD, PharmD, MBA

- Elected president-elect of ISPOR
- Visiting Professor, University of Bristol, 2024-2025



WPEC SOCIAL RECEPTION

Clayton English, PharmD, BCPP, BCPS, BCGP

- UW Medicine Pharmacy Services/University of Washington-PGY2 Psychiatry Program Preceptor of the Year 2024-2025
- Grants Awarded:

  Designing an optimal continuum of care network for youth mental health services in Washington State. Population Health Initiative (PHI)-University of Washington. August 2025 – January 2027. Co-investigator. Total costs: $150,000.

  A New Model of Care for Medications for Opioid Use Disorder Maintenance at Community Pharmacies: A Pilot Effectiveness-Implementation Study. Population Health Initiative (PHI)-University of Washington. August 2025 – January 2027. Co-principal investigator. Total costs: $250,000.



CHOICE FACULTY BID FAREWELL TO THE COLLEGE INN PUB.

Lou Garrison, PhD

- Spoke at the ACCESS Forum in Barcelona on global access to medical innovation and ATMP challenges in lower-income European countries
- Taught short courses on valuing innovative drugs at ISPOR EU (Barcelona) and ISPOR International (Montreal)
- Participated in the first Latin American ACCESS Forum (São Paulo), teaching on pharmaceutical market design and speaking on LATAM's role in global differential pricing



DR. GARRISON PRESENTS AT ACCESS FORUM.



DRS. BASU AND GARRISON CONNECT WITH WPEC KEYNOTE SPEAKER, DR. DARIUS LAKDAWALLA



WPEC SOCIAL RECEPTION

Shelly Gray, PharmD, MPH

- Grant Awarded: Implementation and Evaluation of Fall-related Injury Prevention Strategies in the Lummi Nation (Kushang PI). 8/1/25 to 1/31/27. University of Washington Population Health Initiative Tier 3 Pilot Research Grant, $199,996, Co-Investigator (10%).
- Selected for the 2025-26 Fulbright U.S. Scholar Program, Chinese Medical University, Taichung, Taiwan

Ryan Hansen, PharmD, PhD

- Moderated a session on the impact of HEOR on health care decision making at the annual UW School of Pharmacy Dean's Recognition Reception alongside CHOICE Graduates Ashley Tabah, Zizi Elsisi, and Felipe Montano-Campos
- Continuing longstanding relationship with Bayer Pharmaceuticals in support of our HEOR Fellowship
- Co-Investigator on the Population Health Initiative Tier 3 pilot research grant: A New Model of Care for Medications for Opioid Use Disorder Maintenance at Community Pharmacies: A Pilot Effectiveness-Implementation Study





Noémi Kreif, PhD

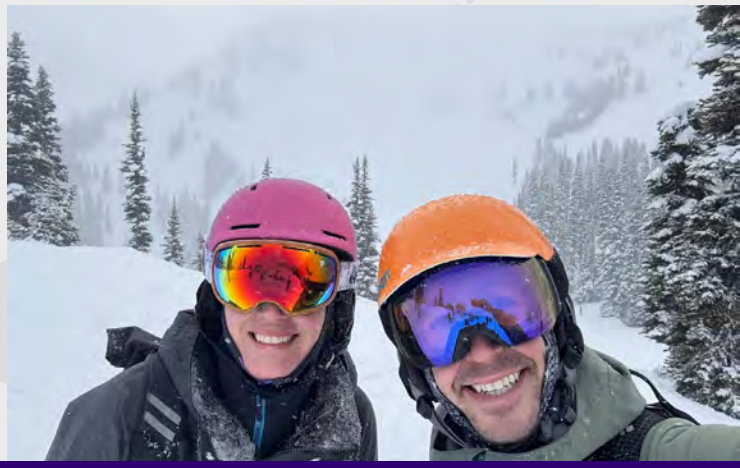
- Podium presentation at SMDM 2024: Can Machine Learning Tools Inform Personalized Treatment Recommendations?
- Co-Director. Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program in Health Economics and Outcomes Research, AbbVie. 2025-2027
- Panel Speaker, WPEC, April 2025: Modern Machine Learning and AI Methods in HEOR

Kyueun Lee, PhD

- Appointment as an affiliated assistant professor at the UW Center for Studies in Demography and Ecology (CIDE)
- Co-Director. Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program in Health Economics and Outcomes Research, AbbVie. 2025-2027

Jing Li, MA, PhD

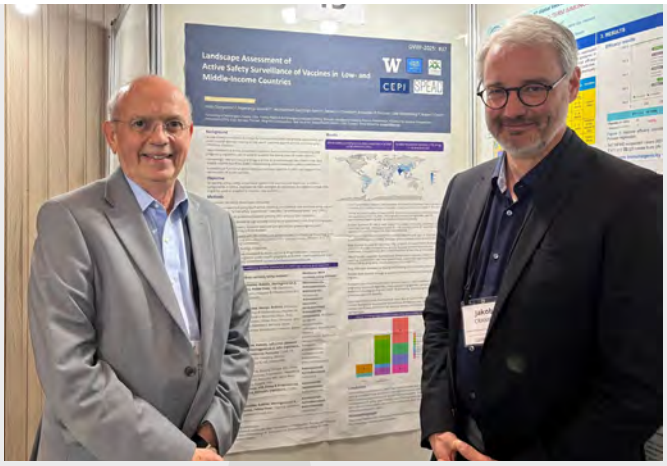
- Appointed Associate Director of The CHOICE Institute
- School of Pharmacy Elected Faculty Council, 2024-2027



ABOVE: CHOICE FELLOWS, STAFF, AND FACULTY, JUNE 2025; TOP RIGHT: DR. KREIF PRESENTS AT SMDM; BOTTOM RIGHT: DRS. KREIF AND BARTHOLD HIT THE SLOPES.

Andy Stergachis, PhD, BPharm

- Grant Awarded: Background Incidence Rates in Africa. Gates Foundation.
- Awarded the Bowl of Hygeia Award for Community Service, November 2024, Washington State Pharmacists Association. This award recognizes an exemplary pharmacist who has made outstanding contributions in the area of community.
- In March 2025, participated in the invitational Global Vaccine and Immunization Research Forum (GVIRF), held March 26–28, 2025, in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, convened by the World Health Organization and Gates Foundation. During the podium session on "Assessing Vaccine Safety in the Post-COVID-19 Pandemic Era," he shared insights on cohort event monitoring for assessing vaccine safety. Stergachis also presented a poster at the Forum titled "Landscape Assessment of Active Safety Surveillance of Vaccines in Low- and Middle-Income Countries."



Sean D. Sullivan, BScPharm, MSc, PhD

- Grant Awarded: Sullivan SD. Principal Investigator – Estimating Savings and Spillover Effects from the IRA. UW CHOICE Health Tech Fund. 2025-2027
- Stuart Schweitzer Distinguished Lecture, UCLA Fielding School of Public Health, January 2025

David Veenstra, PharmD, PhD

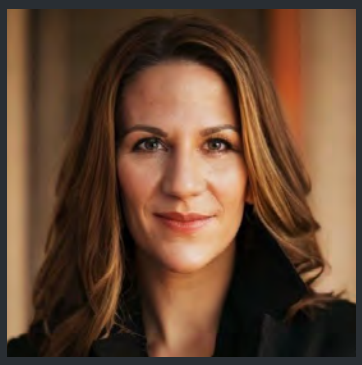
- Director. Post-Doctoral Fellowship Program in Health Economics and Outcomes Research, Genentech. 2025-2027
- Co-Chair, Scientific Committee, 2025 Western PharmacoEconomics Conference







CLOCKWISE FROM TOP RIGHT: DR. STERGACHIS PRESENTING WORK AT GVIRF; CHOICE FACULTY HOLIDAY DINNER, DECEMBER 2024; DRS. LI & KREIF HEADING TO GRADUATION; CHOICE FELLOWS, STAFF, AND FACULTY, JUNE 2025.



Blythe Adamson, MPH, PhD ('18)

- Dr. Adamson established a public-private partnership global research consortium called the FORUM (Fostering Oncology RWE Uses and Methodology) with a focus on testing the transportability of evidence across country borders.
- Served as Chair of the Executive Board for the GetReal Institute.



Mark Bounthavong, PharmD, MPH, PhD ('18)

- Recipient of the 2025 American Foundation for Pharmaceutical Education (AFPE) William M. Heller Mentor of the Year Award. This award honors faculty members nominated by students and colleagues for their exceptional mentorship, commitment, leadership, teaching, and support. Dr. Bounthavong is a professor of clinical pharmacy at University of California San Diego Skaggs School of Pharmacy and Pharmaceutical Sciences; the national clinical program manager at the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) Pharmacy Benefits Management (PBM) Academic Detailing Services; and a health economist at the VA Health Economics Resource Center.

  Mark values the importance of scientific inquiry, critical thinking and optimal decision making, particularly when there is limited evidence. To that end, he has made it his mission to teach the next generation of pharmacists to learn the skills to perform meaningful studies and develop the intuition to apply their findings to their practice and community. Upon being informed of the recognition, Mark shared: "It's been an honor to share my knowledge and experiences with our pharmacy students and to help prepare them for the awesome responsibility that awaits. Our students and their motivation for pursuing a pharmacy career remind me each day why I enjoy being a part of UC San Diego. They are an inspiration for any mentor. It's only natural for a mentor to feel great joy in witnessing the achievements of their mentees. But the greatest reward is knowing that our students will carry on the mission and values of our profession."



Sara Khor, PhD ('24)

- Recipient of the Bruce Schackman Award for Outstanding Presentation in Health Services, Outcomes, and Policy Research. This award was presented at the 46th Annual Society for Medical Decision Making meeting in October 2024, for Sara's dissertation research, "The Health Disparity Impact of Omitting Race from Cancer Risk Prediction: A Microsimulation Study"



Tricia Rodriguez, PhD ('21)

- Dr. Rodriguez spoke with MedScape, USA Today, and CNBC about a recent paper on GLP-1 discontinuation and reinitiation. The paper found differences in discontinuation for people with and without type 2 diabetes, as well as associations with income, weight change, and adverse events. Through her work with Truveta, Dr. Rodriguez has authored numerous studies regarding GLP-1 medications including a study co-authored with Affiliate Professor Davene Wright, on Shifts in U.S. Pediatric Obesity Treatment interventions following 2023 American Academy of Pediatrics (AAP) guidelines regarding early intervention for obesity. (https://publications.aap.org/pediatricsopenscience/article/doi/10.1542/pedsos.2025-000623/202619/Shifts-in-U-S-Pediatric-Obesity-Treatment-After?autologincheck=redirected).
- Dr. Rodriguez was also promoted to Director of Applied Research at Truveta in May 2025.



Jonathan Watanabe, PharmD, MS ('09), PhD ('12)

- Dr. Watanabe chaired the organizing committee for the first ever "Innovations in Pharmacy Training and Practice to Advance Patient Care" workshop held by the National Academy of Medicine. Dr. Jennifer Bacci also served on the organizing committee as a NAM fellow. At a time when workforce challenges affect all healthcare professions, there is an opportunity to examine the full spectrum of pharmacists' contributions to the healthcare system. Student and staffing shortages continue to impact this profession with far-reaching implications for the industry and society. This workshop discussed new models in which pharmacists have expanded roles in health care delivery systems, strategies for collaborative care environments that reduce clinician burnout, next generation training, and ways to eliminate pharmacy deserts. https://www.nationalacademies.org/event/44193_03-2025_innovations-in-pharmacy-training-and-practice-to-advance-patient-care-a-workshop

CAREER UPDATES

Emma Behan, PharmD, MS ('24):
Associate Health Economist- Oncology, Women's Health, Genentech

Carrie Bennette, MPH, PhD ('15)
Staff AI Engineer, Weave

Jennifer Deem, PhD, MS ('24)
Senior Manager, US HTA, Value & Evidence, Oncology Hematology, Pfizer

Jake Earl, PharmD, MS ('24)
Senior Manager, HEOR - US Medical Affairs, Cardiovascular & Renal, Bayer

Simi Grewal Davis, MHS, PhD ('19)
Senior Director, Commercial Forecasting & Advanced Analytics, Vera Therapeutics, Inc.

Filmon Haile, PharmD, MS ('24)
Senior Manager, AbbVie

Zsolt Hepp, PharmD, MS ('13)
Head of HEOR, Bicycle Therapeutics

Katelyn Keyloun, PharmD ('14), MS ('15)
Director, Product Innovation and Development, ARYSANA

Ashley Kim, PharmD, MS ('19)
Associate Director, Health Economics & Outcomes Research, Apellis Pharmaceuticals

Enrique Saldarriaga, MS, PhD ('22)
Director of Public Health and Policy, American Dental Education Association

Richard Ta, PharmD, MS ('24)
Clinical Project Manager III, HEOR, AbbVie

PUBLICATIONS

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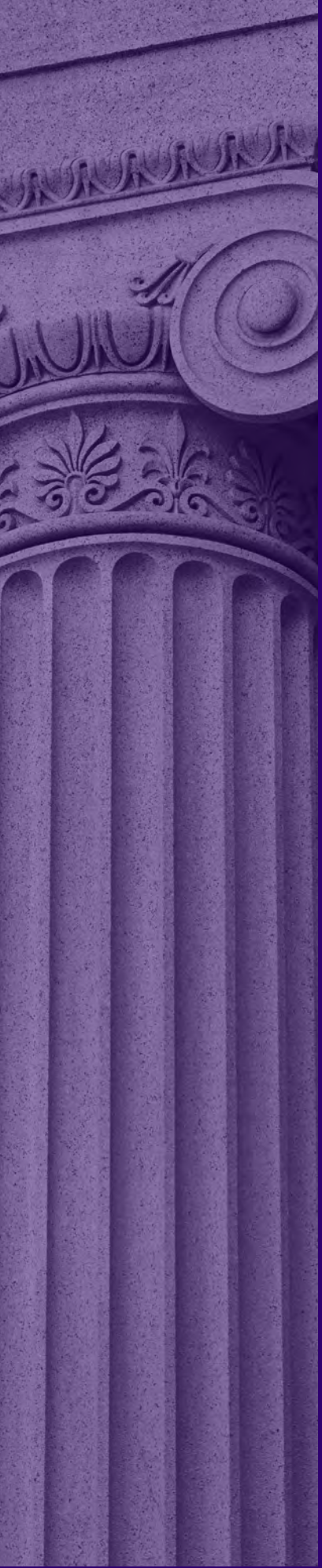
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